

THE CARE COLLECTION • BOOK 9

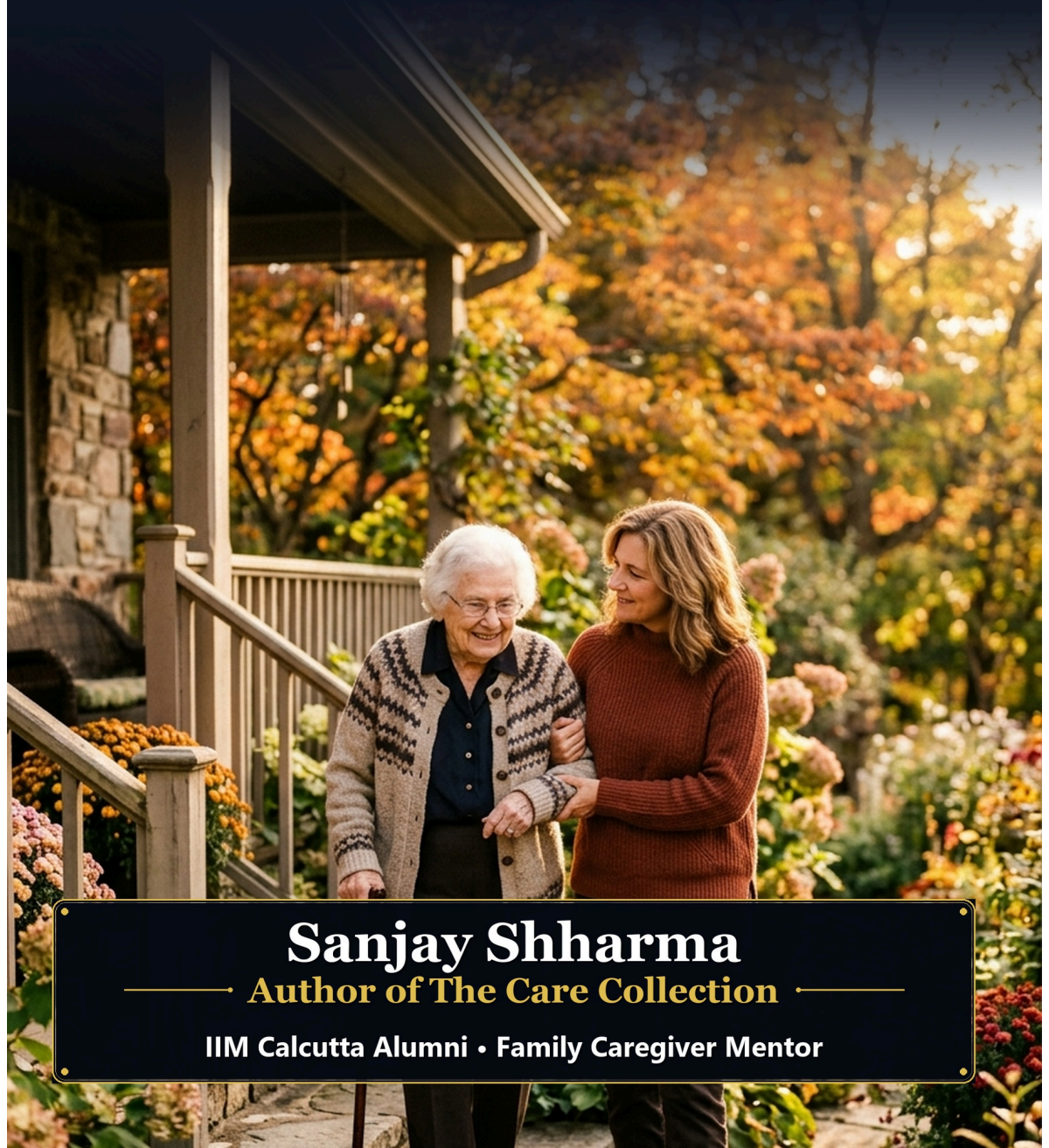


The Last Sandwich

Caring for Parents, Spouse, and Yourself at the Same Time

How the Family's Last Line of Care Holds On

A 4-Phase Framework for the Family Caregiver



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The Last Sandwich

How the Family's Last Line of Care Holds On at 55+

What to Do When You're Caring for Your Parent AND
Your Child AND Your Marriage — and No One Else Is
Coming

A 4-Phase Framework for the Last Caregiver in the
Family Line

by Sanjay Shharma

Author of The Care Collection

Copyright Page

The Last Sandwich: How the Family's Last Line of Care Holds On at 55+

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This is a work of nonfiction. All names, identifying details, and composite case studies have been changed to protect the privacy of the individuals involved. The case studies in this book are composites drawn from research, common patterns, and the work of therapists, mediators, and geriatric care managers. Any resemblance to specific individuals is coincidental.

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Disclaimer: This book is informational and is not a substitute for legal, financial, medical, or therapeutic advice. Elder care is a complex field with legal, financial, medical, and emotional dimensions that require qualified professionals. The author is not a lawyer, financial planner, doctor, or licensed therapist. The content of this book is for informational and educational purposes only. Please consult qualified professionals in your jurisdiction before

making any decisions about elder care, your marriage, or your finances.

If you are in crisis as a result of the issues discussed in this book, please reach out to a qualified mental health professional, a crisis line, or a trusted member of your community. The resources section at the back of this book includes crisis contacts in multiple countries.

Crisis Resources (US):

- 988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline: 988
- Crisis Text Line: Text HOME to 741741
- SAMHSA National Helpline: 1-800-662-4357
- Eldercare Locator: 1-800-677-1116

Crisis Resources (UK):

- Samaritans: 116 123
- Age UK: 0800 055 6112
- Carers UK: 0808 808 7777

Crisis Resources (India):

- iCall: 9152987821
- Vandrevala Foundation: 1860-2662-345
- HelpAge India: 1800-180-1253

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Dedication

For the only child who became the caregiver.

For the sibling who held the phone, waiting for the call that never came from the other siblings.

For the daughter who moved back home at 58, leaving her own life to care for a parent who no longer remembered her name.

For the son who had to choose between his mother's last years and his wife's next years.

For the husband who watched his wife disappear into caregiving, and lost her not to another man, but to her own mother.

For the wife who watched her husband become a stranger, hollowed out by the slow goodbye of his father.

For the adult child caring for a parent while their own child is in crisis.

For the spouse who is holding the marriage together while the other is holding the parent together.

For the one who is the last one.

The last sandwich in the line.

This book is for you.

A Note from the Author

I have not been the only child.

I have not been the one who got the call at 2am. I have not been the one who flew home to find the house in disarray, the parent confused, the siblings nowhere to be found. I have not been the one who moved back home at 55, or 60, or 65, to be the last line of care for a parent who was leaving.

But I have been close.

I have been a caregiver. I have been married to a caregiver. I have watched my own wife become the primary caregiver for her own father, in his last years. I have watched her carry the weight, and the work, and the silent grief. I have watched her be the one who was there, every day, while others were not. I have watched what it cost her - her time, her sleep, her health, her joy, her marriage. I have watched what it cost us.

I have also been on my own long goodbye - the loss of my wife to cancer, after many years of marriage. I know what it is to be the one who is there, at the end, while others are not. I know what it is to be the last line of care. I know what it is to hold the marriage, and the parent, and the grief, all at once.

I write this book for the adult child who is the last one in the line. The one who has no sibling to share the load. The one who has no adult child who can take over. The one who is holding the parent, the marriage, the work, the finances, the grief, and the new identity, all at once.

You are not alone. The work is the work. The work is the holding. The holding is the work.

Welcome.

— S. Shharma

Quick Start

If you have just opened this book and you do not have time to read it cover to cover right now, start here.

You are in one of four phases. Find yours:

Phase 1: The Last Sandwich - You are starting to realize that you are the only one. The siblings are not helping. The parent is aging. The marriage is under pressure. The question is forming: Am I the last one? Read Chapters 1-4.

Phase 2: The Cost - You are past the recognition. You are facing the actual realities - the financial, the emotional, the physical, the marriage, the identity. You are trying to figure out what this is costing you. Read Chapters 5-9.

Phase 3: The Conversation - You are at the conversation point. With the siblings. With the parent. With the spouse. With the adult children. With yourself. Read Chapters 10-14.

Phase 4: The Letting Go - You have decided. You are now in the letting go - of the old self, of the parent, of the plan, of the last sandwich. Read Chapters 15-18 and the Epilogue.

If you are in crisis right now - go to Bonus Toolkit II: The Caregiver's First Aid Kit. It has 7 things you can do in the next 24 hours.

If you do not know whether to take on the caregiving - go to Bonus Toolkit I: The Family Conversation Scripts. The 4 conversations are there.

If your siblings will not help - go to Bonus Toolkit III: The Sibling Equity Worksheet. The math is there.

If you are the long-distance caregiver - go to Bonus Toolkit IV: The Long-Distance Caregiver's Playbook. The 7 decisions are there.

If you have already lost the parent - go to Bonus Toolkit V: The After Book. The 5 things to know are there.

One thing this book is not: a legal guide. Elder care law is a complex field, and the laws are different in every jurisdiction. The elder law attorneys, geriatric care managers, and family therapists who specialize in this work are the right people to advise you on the legal, financial, and medical specifics. This book is the emotional and practical work of being the last one in the line.

Welcome. The work is the work. The holding is the work.

Introduction: The Last Sandwich

There is a sandwich generation. The phrase is well known - the generation in the middle, caring for the parents above and the children below, in the form the sandwich generation now takes. The phrase is real, and the work is real.

But there is a second sandwich generation. A less-talked-about generation. A generation that is not just in the middle. A generation that is the last one in the line. The last sandwich in the family. The one who has no one to hand off to. The one who is the only child, or the only sibling who stepped up, or the only adult child who can be there. The one who is the family's last line of care.

This book is about the last sandwich.

I am writing this book for the adult child who is the last one in the line. The one who is caring for a parent in the last years, the last months, the last days, in the form the last years now take. The one who is holding the marriage, the parent, the work, the finances, the grief, all at once. The one who has no sibling to share the load. The one who has no adult child who can take over. The one who is the end of the family line.

I am writing this book for the only child. For the daughter who moved back home at 58 to care for a mother who no longer remembers her name. For the son who flew home every month, at his own expense, while his siblings refused to come. For the adult child caring for a parent while their own child is in crisis. For the husband who watched his wife disappear into caregiving. For the wife who watched her husband

hollow out from the slow goodbye.

I am writing this book for the 53 million Americans who are unpaid family caregivers - and for the subset of those who are the only one, in the form the only one now takes. The subset who are the last sandwich.

I am writing this book for you, in the form the "you" now takes, if you are the one who is the last one. The one who has no one to hand off to. The one who is holding it all, in the form the holding now takes.

Why this book is different.

There are books about the sandwich generation. There are books about elder care. There are books about caregiving. There are books about the marriage under stress. There are books about the grief of losing a parent. There are books that are practical, or memoir, or self-help.

This book is none of those. This book is the last sandwich book. The book for the adult child who is the only one. The book for the spouse of the only one. The book for the family of the only one. The book that says, You are the last line of care. The work is yours. The cost is yours. The holding is yours. The letting go will be yours. And there is a way to do this without losing yourself, your marriage, your health, or your future.

This book is the book I wish had existed, in the years my wife was the caregiver for her own father, and the years I was the husband of the caregiver, in the form the husband now takes. The book that names the cost. The book that gives you the conversations. The book that walks you through the decisions, step by step, with the dignity the decisions deserve.

What this book is not.

This book is not a legal guide. Elder care law is a complex field, and the laws are different in every jurisdiction. The elder law attorneys, geriatric care managers, and family therapists who specialize in this work are the right people to advise you on the legal, financial, and medical specifics. This book is for the thinking. For the deciding. For the conversations that have to happen before the professionals get involved.

This book is not a memoir. I have not been the only child. I have not been the one who got the call at 2am. I have not been the one who flew home to find the house in disarray, the parent confused, the siblings nowhere to be found.

I have been close. I have been a caregiver. I have watched my own wife become the primary caregiver for her own father, in his last years, in the form the last years now take. I have watched her carry the weight, and the work, and the silent grief. I have watched her be the one who was there, every day, while others were not. I have watched what it cost her. I have watched what it cost us.

I have also been on my own long goodbye - the loss of my wife to cancer, after many years of marriage. I know what it is to be the one who is there, at the end, while others are not. I know what it is to be the last line of care. I know what it is to hold the marriage, and the parent, and the grief, all at once.

This book is the synthesis of what I have learned, in the room with the caregivers, in the years of my own caregiving, in the work of being a coach, in the form the work now takes.

What you will find in this book.

This book is organized around a 4-phase framework, the four questions of the last sandwich:

Phase 1: The Last Sandwich - Am I the only one? Chapters 1-4. The recognition. The reasons. The sibling equation. The moment you realize there is no one to hand off to.

Phase 2: The Cost - What is this costing me? Chapters 5-9. The financial. The emotional. The physical. The marriage. The identity.

Phase 3: The Conversation - How do I have the conversations that have to be had? Chapters 10-14. With the siblings. With the parent. With the spouse. With the adult children. With yourself.

Phase 4: The Letting Go - How do I let go, and what comes after? Chapters 15-18. Of the old self. Of the parent. Of the plan. Of the last sandwich.

Plus 5 bonus toolkits (the Family Conversation Scripts, the Caregiver's First Aid Kit, the Sibling Equity Worksheet, the Long-Distance Caregiver's Playbook, the After Book), 5 case studies of real-pattern families, and a research appendix with 12+ peer-reviewed citations.

The book is 200+ pages. The book is meant to be read slowly, in the small moments, in the long evenings, in the form the reading now takes. The book is meant to be a companion, in the form the companion now takes.

Who this book is for.

This book is for you, if you are the adult child who is the last one in the line. If you are the spouse of the last one. If you are the friend, the sibling, the colleague, who is trying to understand the last one. If you are the professional - the geriatric care manager, the elder law attorney, the family therapist, the financial planner - who is working with the last ones.

This book is for the last sandwich in the line.

The work is the work. The holding is the work. The letting go is the work.

Welcome.

Chapter 1: The Last Sandwich

Every family has a last sandwich. The last sandwich is the adult child who is the final line of care, in the form the final line of care now takes. The last sandwich is the one who has no sibling to share the load. The last sandwich is the one who has no adult child who can take over. The last sandwich is the end of the family line.

The last sandwich is real. The last sandwich is you, if you are reading this book. The last sandwich is the work, in the form the work now takes.

This chapter is about the last sandwich. About the work of recognizing that you are the last one. About the holding of the recognition, in the form the holding now takes.

What the last sandwich is.

The last sandwich is the adult child who has become the primary, or the only, caregiver for an aging parent, in the form the caregiver now takes. The last sandwich is the one who has taken on the responsibility, in the form the responsibility now takes. The last sandwich is the one who is there, every day, while others are not.

The last sandwich is not a metaphor. The last sandwich is the actual, real, lived experience of being the final carrier of the family. The last sandwich is the one who has to do it all, in the form the doing now takes.

The last sandwich is not chosen. The last sandwich is the one who stepped up, in the form the stepping up now takes. The last sandwich is the one who was

there, when no one else was. The last sandwich is the one who could not say no, in the form the saying no now takes.

What the last sandwich is not.

The last sandwich is not the only one who loves the parent. The last sandwich is the one who is there, in the form the "there" now takes. The siblings may love the parent. The siblings may even want to help. The siblings may be unable, in the form the unable now takes. The siblings may be unwilling, in the form the unwilling now takes. The siblings may be absent, in the form the absent now takes.

The last sandwich is not the martyr. The last sandwich is the one who is doing the work, in the form the work now takes. The last sandwich is the one who has not been relieved, in the form the relieved now takes.

The last sandwich is not alone. The last sandwich is the one who is the only one in the family, in the form the only one now takes. The last sandwich has the spouse, the friends, the therapist, the geriatric care manager, the elder law attorney. The last sandwich is alone in the family, but not alone in the work.

The shape of the last sandwich.

The last sandwich has a shape. The last sandwich is the adult child of an aging parent. The last sandwich is the one who has been carrying the load, in the form the carrying now takes. The last sandwich is the one who is in the kitchen at 2am, waiting for the call, in the form the waiting now takes.

The last sandwich is the only child of an aging parent. The last sandwich is the sibling who stepped up while the others stepped back. The last sandwich is the spouse of the only child, in the form the spouse now

takes. The last sandwich is the adult child of a parent who has no other family, in the form the no other family now takes.

The last sandwich is the shape of the family, in the form the shape now takes. The last sandwich is the shape of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes. The last sandwich is the shape of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes.

The work of the last sandwich.

The work of the last sandwich is the work of caregiving. The work of the last sandwich is the work of holding the parent, in the form the holding now takes. The work of the last sandwich is the work of holding the marriage, in the form the holding now takes. The work of the last sandwich is the work of holding the self, in the form the holding now takes.

The work of the last sandwich is also the work of recognizing. The work of the last sandwich is the work of recognizing that you are the last one, in the form the recognizing now takes. The work of the last sandwich is the work of recognizing that there is no one to hand off to, in the form the recognizing now takes. The work of the last sandwich is the work of recognizing that the cost is real, in the form the cost now takes.

The work of the last sandwich is also the work of letting go. The work of the last sandwich is the work of letting go of the old self, in the form the letting go now takes. The work of the last sandwich is the work of letting go of the parent, in the form the letting go now takes. The work of the last sandwich is the work of letting go of the plan, in the form the letting go now takes.

The holding of the last sandwich.

The holding of the last sandwich is the work of being the one who is there, in the form the being there now takes. The holding of the last sandwich is the work of being the one who answers the phone at 2am, in the form the answering now takes. The holding of the last sandwich is the work of being the one who shows up, in the form the showing up now takes.

The holding of the last sandwich is also the work of being held. The holding of the last sandwich is the work of being held by the spouse, in the form the holding now takes. The holding of the last sandwich is the work of being held by the friends, in the form the holding now takes. The holding of the last sandwich is the work of being held by the therapist, in the form the holding now takes.

The holding of the last sandwich is the work, in the form the work now takes. The holding of the last sandwich is the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes. The holding of the last sandwich is the letting go, in the form the letting go now takes.

The work of this chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the last sandwich. The work of this chapter is to recognize the last sandwich, in the form the recognizing now takes. The work of this chapter is to hold the last sandwich, in the form the holding now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the first phase of the last sandwich. The work of this chapter is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the last sandwich.

Chapter 1 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The last sandwich is the adult child who is the final line of care, in the form the final line of care now takes. The last sandwich is the one who has no sibling to share the load. The last sandwich is the end of the family line. The last sandwich is the work, in the form the work now takes.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The last sandwich is the adult child who has become the primary, or the only, caregiver for an aging parent.
2. The last sandwich is not chosen. The last sandwich is the one who stepped up, while others stepped back.
3. The last sandwich is not the martyr. The last sandwich is the one who is doing the work.
4. The last sandwich is the work of recognizing, holding, and letting go.
5. The last sandwich is the holding of the work, and the work of being held.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize that I am the last sandwich, in the form the recognizing now takes.
- I am holding the recognition, in the form the holding now takes.
- I have begun to ask the question, in the form the asking now takes.
- I have not yet named the question to my spouse, or to myself, in a way that commits me to the work.

If your total is 12 or higher, the next chapter - and the next phase - cannot wait.

Key Terms to Know:

- The last sandwich: The adult child who is the final line of care, in the form the final line of care now takes. The one who has no sibling to share the load. The end of the family line.
- The sandwich generation: The generation in the middle, caring for the parents above and the children below, in the form the sandwich generation now takes.
- The only child: The adult child who is the only one, in the form the only one now takes. The one who has no sibling, by birth or by circumstance.
- The letting go: The work of releasing the old self, the parent, the plan, the last sandwich, in the form the letting go now takes.

Reflection Questions:

1. Are you the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes?
2. Who in your family is the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes?
3. What is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes, that you are carrying today?

Action for This Week:

- Find one quiet moment, alone, and write down, in the form the writing now takes, the answer to one of the reflection questions. Not for anyone else. For you. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the last sandwich. The last sandwich is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 2: The 6 Reasons You Became the Last One

There are 6 reasons the last sandwich became the last one, in the form the last one now takes. The 6 reasons are the 6 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

This chapter is about the 6 reasons. About the work of recognizing which of the 6 reasons is in your family, in the form your family now takes. About the holding of the recognition, in the form the holding now takes.

Why the 6 reasons matter.

The 6 reasons matter because the 6 reasons are the 6 patterns, in the form the patterns now take. The 6 reasons are the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The 6 reasons are not the fault of the last sandwich, in the form the fault now takes. The 6 reasons are the shape of the family, in the form the shape now takes.

The 6 reasons matter because the 6 reasons help the last sandwich name the work, in the form the naming now takes. The 6 reasons are the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes. The 6 reasons are the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Reason 1: The only child.

The first reason the last sandwich became the last one, in the form the last one now takes, is the only child. The only child is the adult child who has no sibling, by birth, in the form the no sibling now takes. The only child is the one who has been the only one since the beginning, in the form the only one now

takes.

The only child has been the only one for the parent's caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes. The only child has been the one who has answered the phone, in the form the answering now takes. The only child has been the one who has shown up, in the form the showing up now takes.

The only child is the last sandwich by circumstance, in the form the circumstance now takes. The only child is not chosen. The only child is the one who has been the only one, in the form the only one now takes.

Reason 2: The sibling who stepped up.

The second reason the last sandwich became the last one, in the form the last one now takes, is the sibling who stepped up. The sibling who stepped up is the adult child who, when the caregiving became real, in the form the caregiving now takes, was the one who said yes, in the form the saying yes now takes.

The sibling who stepped up is the one who lived closer, in the form the closer now takes. The sibling who stepped up is the one who had fewer children, in the form the children now takes. The sibling who stepped up is the one who had a more flexible job, in the form the job now takes. The sibling who stepped up is the one who could not say no, in the form the saying no now takes.

The sibling who stepped up is the last sandwich by choice, in the form the choice now takes. The sibling who stepped up is the one who is doing the work, in the form the work now takes.

Reason 3: The sibling who stepped back.

The third reason the last sandwich became the last one, in the form the last one now takes, is the sibling

who stepped back. The sibling who stepped back is the adult child who, when the caregiving became real, in the form the caregiving now takes, was the one who said no, in the form the saying no now takes.

The sibling who stepped back is the one who lives far away, in the form the far away now takes. The sibling who stepped back is the one who has a busy career, in the form the career now takes. The sibling who stepped back is the one who has a difficult marriage, in the form the marriage now takes. The sibling who stepped back is the one who has always been the one who steps back, in the form the stepping back now takes.

The sibling who stepped back is the one who is not the last sandwich, in the form the not now takes. The sibling who stepped back is the one who has not been there, in the form the being there now takes.

Reason 4: The sibling who is unable.

The fourth reason the last sandwich became the last one, in the form the last one now takes, is the sibling who is unable. The sibling who is unable is the adult child who, when the caregiving became real, in the form the caregiving now takes, was the one who could not, in the form the could not now takes.

The sibling who is unable is the one who has a disability, in the form the disability now takes. The sibling who is unable is the one who has a serious illness, in the form the illness now takes. The sibling who is unable is the one who has a child with special needs, in the form the special needs now takes. The sibling who is unable is the one who has a financial crisis, in the form the financial crisis now takes.

The sibling who is unable is the one who is not the last sandwich by choice, in the form the choice now takes.

The sibling who is unable is the one who is held by the last sandwich, in the form the holding now takes.

Reason 5: The sibling who is unwilling.

The fifth reason the last sandwich became the last one, in the form the last one now takes, is the sibling who is unwilling. The sibling who is unwilling is the adult child who, when the caregiving became real, in the form the caregiving now takes, was the one who chose not to, in the form the choosing not now takes.

The sibling who is unwilling is the one who has a long-standing conflict with the parent, in the form the conflict now takes. The sibling who is unwilling is the one who has a different value system, in the form the value system now takes. The sibling who is unwilling is the one who is in active addiction, in the form the addiction now takes. The sibling who is unwilling is the one who has chosen their own family over the parent's, in the form the choosing now takes.

The sibling who is unwilling is the one who has chosen, in the form the choosing now takes. The last sandwich cannot make the sibling who is unwilling change, in the form the changing now takes.

Reason 6: The sibling who is absent.

The sixth reason the last sandwich became the last one, in the form the last one now takes, is the sibling who is absent. The sibling who is absent is the adult child who, when the caregiving became real, in the form the caregiving now takes, was the one who was gone, in the form the gone now takes.

The sibling who is absent is the one who has been estranged for years, in the form the estrangement now takes. The sibling who is absent is the one who lives in another country, in the form the country now

takes. The sibling who is absent is the one who has cut off all contact, in the form the cutting off now takes. The sibling who is absent is the one who was never there, in the form the being there now takes.

The sibling who is absent is the one who has not been there, in the form the being there now takes. The last sandwich cannot make the sibling who is absent appear, in the form the appearing now takes.

The 6 reasons in summary.

The 6 reasons the last sandwich became the last one, in the form the last one now takes, are:

1. The only child
2. The sibling who stepped up
3. The sibling who stepped back
4. The sibling who is unable
5. The sibling who is unwilling
6. The sibling who is absent

The 6 reasons are not the only reasons. The 6 reasons are the most common reasons. The 6 reasons are the 6 reasons that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the 6 reasons. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, which of the 6 reasons is in your family, in the form your family now takes. The work of this chapter is to hold the recognition, in the form the holding now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the second phase of the last sandwich. The work of this chapter is the work of the 6 reasons, in the form the 6 reasons now take.

The work of this chapter is the work of the reasons.

Chapter 2 at a Glance

Key takeaway: There are 6 reasons the last sandwich became the last one, in the form the last one now takes. The 6 reasons are the patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up most often in the work of the last sandwich.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 6 reasons are: only child, sibling who stepped up, sibling who stepped back, sibling who is unable, sibling who is unwilling, sibling who is absent.
2. The 6 reasons are not the fault of the last sandwich, in the form the fault now takes.
3. The 6 reasons are the shape of the family, in the form the shape now takes.
4. The last sandwich cannot make the siblings change, in the form the changing now takes.
5. The 6 reasons are the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize which of the 6 reasons is in my family, in the form my family now takes.
- I am holding the recognition, in the form the holding now takes.
- I have not yet named the recognition to my spouse, or to my siblings, in a way that commits me to the work.
- I am willing to look at the 6 reasons, in the form the looking now takes.

If your total is 12 or higher, the next chapter cannot wait.

Key Terms to Know:

- The only child: The adult child who has no sibling, by birth, in the form the no sibling now takes.
- The sibling who stepped up: The adult child who, when the caregiving became real, said yes, in the form the saying yes now takes.
- The sibling who stepped back: The adult child who said no, in the form the saying no now takes.
- The sibling who is unable: The adult child who could not, in the form the could not now takes.
- The sibling who is unwilling: The adult child who chose not to, in the form the choosing not now takes.
- The sibling who is absent: The adult child who was gone, in the form the gone now takes.

Reflection Questions:

1. Which of the 6 reasons is in your family, in the form your family now takes?
2. When did the 6 reasons first show up, in the form the showing up now takes?
3. What would it look like to name the 6 reasons, in the form the naming now takes, to your spouse, to your siblings?

Action for This Week:

- Find one quiet moment, alone, and write down, in the form the writing now takes, the answer to one of the reflection questions. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the 6 reasons. The 6 reasons are the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 3: The Sibling Equation

The sibling equation is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The sibling equation is the math of the caregiving, in the form the math now takes. The sibling equation is who is doing what, in the form the doing what now takes.

This chapter is about the sibling equation. About the work of the math, in the form the math now takes. About the work of the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes. About the holding of the equation, in the form the holding now takes.

Why the sibling equation is the hardest math.

The sibling equation is the hardest math, in the form the hardest now takes, because the sibling equation is the work of the family, in the form the work now takes. The sibling equation is the work of the relationship, in the form the relationship now takes. The sibling equation is the work of the history, in the form the history now takes.

The sibling equation is the hardest math, in the form the hardest now takes, because the sibling equation is the work of the love, in the form the love now takes. The sibling equation is the work of the resentment, in the form the resentment now takes. The sibling equation is the work of the grief, in the form the grief now takes.

The sibling equation is the hardest math, in the form the hardest now takes, because the sibling equation is the work of the long story, in the form the long story now takes. The sibling equation is the work of the long relationship, in the form the long relationship now

takes. The sibling equation is the work of the long history, in the form the long history now takes.

The 4 forms the sibling equation takes.

There are 4 forms the sibling equation takes, in the form the taking now takes. The 4 forms are the 4 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Form 1: The one who does everything.

The one who does everything is the last sandwich who is the only one doing the caregiving, in the form the only one now takes. The one who does everything is the one who is there, in the form the "there" now takes. The one who does everything is the one who is doing the work, in the form the work now takes.

The one who does everything is also the one who is resented, in the form the resented now takes. The one who does everything is also the one who is criticized, in the form the criticized now takes. The one who does everything is also the one who is told how to do it, by the siblings who are not doing it, in the form the not doing it now takes.

Form 2: The one who does nothing.

The one who does nothing is the sibling who is not doing the caregiving, in the form the not now takes. The one who does nothing is the one who is not there, in the form the not "there" now takes. The one who does nothing is the one who is not doing the work, in the form the work now takes.

The one who does nothing is also the one who is resented, in the form the resented now takes. The one who does nothing is also the one who is judged, in the form the judged now takes. The one who does nothing

is also the one who is told to step up, by the siblings who are not stepping up, in the form the not stepping up now takes.

Form 3: The one who does a little.

The one who does a little is the sibling who is doing some of the caregiving, in the form the some now takes. The one who does a little is the one who is there sometimes, in the form the sometimes now takes. The one who does a little is the one who is doing some of the work, in the form the some now takes.

The one who does a little is also the one who is thanked more than the one who does everything, in the form the thanked more now takes. The one who does a little is also the one who is seen, in the form the seen now takes. The one who does a little is also the one who is celebrated, in the form the celebrated now takes.

Form 4: The one who does the most.

The one who does the most is the last sandwich who is doing more than the siblings, in the form the more now takes. The one who does the most is the one who is there the most, in the form the most now takes. The one who does the most is the one who is doing the most work, in the form the most now takes.

The one who does the most is also the one who is resented the most, in the form the resented the most now takes. The one who does the most is also the one who is held the most, in the form the held the most now takes. The one who does the most is also the one who is invisible the most, in the form the invisible now takes.

The 4 forms in summary.

The 4 forms the sibling equation takes, in the form the taking now takes, are:

1. The one who does everything
2. The one who does nothing
3. The one who does a little
4. The one who does the most

The 4 forms are not the only forms. The 4 forms are the most common forms. The 4 forms are the 4 forms that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The math of the sibling equation.

The math of the sibling equation is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The math of the sibling equation is the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes. The math of the sibling equation is the work of the family, in the form the work now takes.

The math of the sibling equation is the work of the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes. The math of the sibling equation is the work of the boundary, in the form the boundary now takes. The math of the sibling equation is the work of the equity, in the form the equity now takes.

The 7 questions to ask the siblings.

There are 7 questions to ask the siblings, in the form the asking now takes. The 7 questions are the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The 7 questions are the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes.

1. Are you willing to be part of the caregiving, in the form the part now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

2. Are you willing to be part of the finances, in the form the finances now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

3. Are you willing to be part of the medical decisions, in the form the medical now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

4. Are you willing to be part of the end-of-life decisions, in the form the end-of-life now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

5. Are you willing to be part of the visits, in the form the visits now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

6. Are you willing to be part of the emotional support, in the form the emotional now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

7. Are you willing to be part of the after, in the form the after now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 questions in summary.

The 7 questions to ask the siblings, in the form the asking now takes, are:

1. Caregiving
2. Finances
3. Medical decisions
4. End-of-life decisions
5. Visits
6. Emotional support
7. The after

The 7 questions are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 questions are the protection, in the

form the protection now takes. The 7 questions are the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the sibling equation. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, which of the 4 forms the sibling equation takes, in the form your family now takes. The work of this chapter is to ask the 7 questions, in the form the asking now takes, to the siblings, in the form the asking now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the third phase of the last sandwich. The work of this chapter is the work of the sibling equation, in the form the sibling equation now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the equation.

Chapter 3 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The sibling equation is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The 4 forms the equation takes, in the form the taking now takes, are: the one who does everything, the one who does nothing, the one who does a little, the one who does the most. The 7 questions are the work, in the form the work now takes.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The sibling equation is the hardest math, in the form the hardest now takes, because it is the math of the family, the love, the resentment, the grief.
2. The 4 forms the equation takes are: everything, nothing, a little, the most.
3. The 7 questions are the work, in the form the work now takes, of the asking, in the form the asking now takes.

4. The last sandwich cannot make the siblings change, in the form the changing now takes.

5. The sibling equation is the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize which of the 4 forms the sibling equation takes, in the form my family now takes.
- I am willing to ask the 7 questions, in the form the asking now takes, to the siblings, in the form the asking now takes.
- I have not yet named the recognition to my spouse, or to the siblings, in a way that commits me to the work.
- I am willing to hold the equation, in the form the holding now takes.

If your total is 12 or higher, the next chapter cannot wait.

Key Terms to Know:

- The sibling equation: The work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The math of the caregiving, in the form the math now takes.
- The one who does everything: The last sandwich who is the only one doing the caregiving, in the form the only one now takes.
- The one who does nothing: The sibling who is not doing the caregiving, in the form the not now takes.
- The one who does a little: The sibling who is doing some of the caregiving, in the form the some now takes.

- The one who does the most: The last sandwich who is doing more than the siblings, in the form the more now takes.

Reflection Questions:

1. Which of the 4 forms the sibling equation takes, in the form the taking now takes, is in your family, in the form your family now takes?
2. What would it look like to ask the 7 questions, in the form the asking now takes, to the siblings, in the form the asking now takes?
3. What is the math of the sibling equation, in the form the math now takes, that you are carrying today?

Action for This Week:

- Find one quiet moment, alone, and write down, in the form the writing now takes, the answer to one of the reflection questions. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- If you are willing, ask the 7 questions, in the form the asking now takes, to the siblings, in the form the asking now takes. The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the equation. The equation is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 4: The Recognition

The recognition is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The recognition is the moment when the last sandwich knows, in the form the knowing now takes, that there is no one to hand off to, in the form the handing off now takes.

This chapter is about the recognition. About the work of the moment, in the form the moment now takes. About the holding of the recognition, in the form the holding now takes. About the work that comes after the recognition, in the form the work now takes.

Why the recognition is the moment.

The recognition is the moment, in the form the moment now takes, because the recognition is the work, in the form the work now takes. The recognition is the moment when the last sandwich stops hoping, in the form the hoping now takes. The recognition is the moment when the last sandwich starts doing, in the form the doing now takes.

The recognition is the moment, in the form the moment now takes, because the recognition is the work of the family, in the form the work now takes. The recognition is the moment when the last sandwich knows the family, in the form the knowing now takes. The recognition is the moment when the last sandwich knows the siblings, in the form the knowing now takes.

The 5 forms the recognition takes.

The recognition takes 5 forms, in the form the taking now takes. The 5 forms are the 5 moments, in the form the moments now take, that the last sandwich

has the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes.

Form 1: The phone call that does not come.

The first form the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes, is the phone call that does not come. The last sandwich has the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes, when the sibling does not call, in the form the not calling now takes. The last sandwich has the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes, when the phone rings and it is the parent, not the sibling, in the form the not the sibling now takes.

The phone call that does not come is the work, in the form the work now takes. The phone call that does not come is the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes. The phone call that does not come is the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Form 2: The holiday that does not include the parent.

The second form the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes, is the holiday that does not include the parent. The last sandwich has the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes, when the sibling does not invite the parent, in the form the not inviting now takes. The last sandwich has the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes, when the sibling invites the parent and the parent says no, in the form the saying no now takes.

The holiday that does not include the parent is the work, in the form the work now takes. The holiday that does not include the parent is the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes. The holiday that does not include the parent is the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Form 3: The doctor's appointment that only the last sandwich attends.

The third form the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes, is the doctor's appointment that only the last sandwich attends. The last sandwich has the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes, when the sibling does not come to the appointment, in the form the not coming now takes. The last sandwich has the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes, when the parent asks for the last sandwich, not the sibling, in the form the not the sibling now takes.

The doctor's appointment that only the last sandwich attends is the work, in the form the work now takes. The doctor's appointment that only the last sandwich attends is the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes. The doctor's appointment that only the last sandwich attends is the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Form 4: The hospital stay that only the last sandwich works.

The fourth form the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes, is the hospital stay that only the last sandwich works. The last sandwich has the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes, when the sibling does not come to the hospital, in the form the not coming now takes. The last sandwich has the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes, when the parent asks for the last sandwich, not the sibling, in the form the not the sibling now takes.

The hospital stay that only the last sandwich works is the work, in the form the work now takes. The hospital stay that only the last sandwich works is the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes. The hospital stay that only the last sandwich works is

the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Form 5: The funeral that only the last sandwich plans.

The fifth form the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes, is the funeral that only the last sandwich plans. The last sandwich has the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes, when the sibling does not help plan the funeral, in the form the not helping now takes. The last sandwich has the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes, when the sibling shows up for the funeral but did not show up for the life, in the form the not showing up for the life now takes.

The funeral that only the last sandwich plans is the work, in the form the work now takes. The funeral that only the last sandwich plans is the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes. The funeral that only the last sandwich plans is the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

The 5 forms in summary.

The 5 forms the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes, are:

1. The phone call that does not come
2. The holiday that does not include the parent
3. The doctor's appointment that only the last sandwich attends
4. The hospital stay that only the last sandwich works
5. The funeral that only the last sandwich plans

The 5 forms are not the only forms. The 5 forms are the most common forms. The 5 forms are the 5 forms that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the recognition. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, which of the 5 forms the recognition takes, in the form your family now takes. The work of this chapter is to hold the recognition, in the form the holding now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the fourth phase of the last sandwich. The work of this chapter is the work of the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the recognition.

Chapter 4 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The recognition is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The recognition is the moment when the last sandwich knows, in the form the knowing now takes, that there is no one to hand off to. The 5 forms the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes, are the moments, in the form the moments now take, that the last sandwich has the recognition.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The recognition is the moment, in the form the moment now takes, because the recognition is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. The 5 forms the recognition takes are: the phone call that does not come, the holiday that does not include the parent, the doctor's appointment that only the last sandwich attends, the hospital stay that only the last sandwich works, the funeral that only the last sandwich plans.

3. The 5 forms are the moments, in the form the moments now take, that the last sandwich has the recognition, in the form the recognition now takes.

4. The recognition is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the family, in the form the family now takes.

5. The recognition is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize which of the 5 forms the recognition takes, in the form my family now takes.
- I am holding the recognition, in the form the holding now takes.
- I have not yet named the recognition to my spouse, or to myself, in a way that commits me to the work.
- I am willing to do the work, in the form the work now takes, of the recognition.

If your total is 12 or higher, the next phase cannot wait.

Key Terms to Know:

- The recognition: The moment when the last sandwich knows, in the form the knowing now takes, that there is no one to hand off to, in the form the handing off now takes.
- The phone call that does not come: The first form the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes.
- The holiday that does not include the parent: The second form the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes.

- The doctor's appointment that only the last sandwich attends: The third form the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes.
- The hospital stay that only the last sandwich works: The fourth form the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes.
- The funeral that only the last sandwich plans: The fifth form the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes.

Reflection Questions:

1. Which of the 5 forms the recognition takes, in the form the taking now takes, is in your family, in the form your family now takes?
2. What would it look like to name the recognition, in the form the naming now takes, to your spouse, to your siblings, to your therapist?
3. What is the work of the recognition, in the form the work now takes, that you are carrying today?

Action for This Week:

- Find one quiet moment, alone, and write down, in the form the writing now takes, the answer to one of the reflection questions. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- If you are willing, name the recognition, in the form the naming now takes, to your spouse, in the form the naming now takes. The naming is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the recognition. The recognition is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 5: The Financial Cost

The financial cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The financial cost is the money, in the form the money now takes, that the last sandwich is spending, in the form the spending now takes, on the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

This chapter is about the financial cost. About the work of the money, in the form the money now takes. About the holding of the money, in the form the holding now takes. About the work of the financial decisions, in the form the financial decisions now take.

Why the financial cost is brutal at 55+.

The financial cost is brutal at 55+, in the form the brutal now takes, because the money, in the form the money now takes, is the work of the future, in the form the future now takes. The money, in the form the money now takes, is the retirement, in the form the retirement now takes. The money, in the form the money now takes, is the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes. The money, in the form the money now takes, is the kids' college, in the form the kids' college now takes. The money, in the form the money now takes, is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

The financial cost is brutal at 55+, in the form the brutal now takes, because the money, in the form the money now takes, is being spent, in the form the being spent now takes. The money, in the form the money now takes, is being spent on the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes. The money, in the

form the money now takes, is being spent on the parent, in the form the parent now takes. The money, in the form the money now takes, is being spent on the work, in the form the work now takes.

The financial cost is brutal at 55+, in the form the brutal now takes, because the money, in the form the money now takes, is being spent, in the form the being spent now takes, by the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes. The money is being spent by the one who can least afford to spend it, in the form the least afford now takes.

The 7 financial realities of the last sandwich.

There are 7 financial realities of the last sandwich, in the form the realities now take. The 7 realities are the 7 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Reality 1: The lost wages.

The lost wages is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The lost wages is the money, in the form the money now takes, that the last sandwich is not earning, in the form the not earning now takes, because the last sandwich is caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

The lost wages can be thousands of dollars per month, in the form the thousands now takes. The lost wages can be hundreds of thousands of dollars over the caregiving years, in the form the hundreds of thousands now takes. The lost wages is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Reality 2: The out-of-pocket costs.

The out-of-pocket costs is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The

out-of-pocket costs is the money, in the form the money now takes, that the last sandwich is spending, in the form the spending now takes, on the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

The out-of-pocket costs can be for medications, in the form the medications now takes. The out-of-pocket costs can be for transportation, in the form the transportation now takes. The out-of-pocket costs can be for home modifications, in the form the home modifications now takes. The out-of-pocket costs is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Reality 3: The home modifications.

The home modifications is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The home modifications is the work, in the form the work now takes, of making the parent's home safe, in the form the safe now takes. The home modifications is the work, in the form the work now takes, of installing grab bars, in the form the grab bars now takes. The home modifications is the work, in the form the work now takes, of widening doorways, in the form the doorways now takes.

The home modifications can cost thousands of dollars, in the form the thousands now takes. The home modifications can cost tens of thousands of dollars, in the form the tens of thousands now takes. The home modifications is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Reality 4: The in-home care.

The in-home care is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The in-home care is the work, in the form the work now takes, of hiring someone to help, in the form the help now takes. The in-home care is the work, in the form the work now

takes, of paying for the help, in the form the paying now takes.

The in-home care can cost thousands of dollars per month, in the form the thousands now takes. The in-home care can be the largest single cost of the caregiving, in the form the largest now takes. The in-home care is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Reality 5: The assisted living.

The assisted living is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The assisted living is the work, in the form the work now takes, of moving the parent to a facility, in the form the facility now takes. The assisted living is the work, in the form the work now takes, of paying for the facility, in the form the paying now takes.

The assisted living can cost thousands of dollars per month, in the form the thousands now takes. The assisted living can cost hundreds of thousands of dollars over the years, in the form the hundreds of thousands now takes. The assisted living is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Reality 6: The nursing home.

The nursing home is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The nursing home is the work, in the form the work now takes, of moving the parent to a nursing home, in the form the nursing home now takes. The nursing home is the work, in the form the work now takes, of paying for the nursing home, in the form the paying now takes.

The nursing home can cost the most of all the options, in the form the most now takes. The nursing home can cost the parent's entire estate, in the form the entire

estate now takes. The nursing home is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Reality 7: The lost retirement.

The lost retirement is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The lost retirement is the money, in the form the money now takes, that the last sandwich is not saving, in the form the not saving now takes, because the last sandwich is caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

The lost retirement can be hundreds of thousands of dollars, in the form the hundreds of thousands now takes. The lost retirement can change the last sandwich's old age, in the form the changing now takes. The lost retirement is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 realities in summary.

The 7 financial realities of the last sandwich, in the form the realities now take, are:

1. The lost wages
2. The out-of-pocket costs
3. The home modifications
4. The in-home care
5. The assisted living
6. The nursing home
7. The lost retirement

The 7 realities are not the only realities. The 7 realities are the most common realities. The 7 realities are the 7 realities that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The team you need.

The financial cost requires a team, in the form the team now takes. The team is the work, in the form the

work now takes. The team is the support, in the form the support now takes. The team is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The team has 4 members:

1. A financial planner with elder care experience - to advise on the financial, in the form the financial now takes. The financial planner is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. An elder law attorney - to advise on the legal, in the form the legal now takes. The elder law attorney is the work, in the form the work now takes.
3. A geriatric care manager - to advise on the care, in the form the care now takes. The geriatric care manager is the work, in the form the work now takes.
4. A CPA or tax professional - to advise on the tax, in the form the tax now takes. The CPA is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The team is the work, in the form the work now takes. The team is the support, in the form the support now takes. The team is the financial cost, in the form the financial cost now takes.

The 10 questions to ask.

There are 10 questions to ask, in the form the asking now takes. The 10 questions are the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The 10 questions are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. What is the parent's income, in the form the income now takes?
2. What is the parent's assets, in the form the assets now takes?

3. What is the parent's insurance, in the form the insurance now takes?
4. What is the parent's long-term care insurance, in the form the long-term care insurance now takes?
5. What is the parent's Medicaid eligibility, in the form the Medicaid now takes?
6. What is the parent's estate plan, in the form the estate now takes?
7. What is the parent's will, in the form the will now takes?
8. What is the parent's power of attorney, in the form the power of attorney now takes?
9. What is the parent's healthcare proxy, in the form the healthcare proxy now takes?
10. What is the parent's living will, in the form the living will now takes?

The 10 questions in summary.

The 10 questions to ask, in the form the asking now takes, are:

1-2. Income and assets

3-4. Insurance and long-term care insurance

5. Medicaid eligibility

6-7. Estate plan and will

8-10. Power of attorney, healthcare proxy, living will

The 10 questions are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 10 questions are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 10 questions are the financial cost, in the form the financial cost now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the financial cost. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, the 7 financial realities, in the form the realities now take. The work of this chapter is to build the team, in the form the building now takes, and to ask the 10 questions, in the form the asking now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the first phase of the cost. The work of this chapter is the work of the financial cost, in the form the financial cost now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the financial.

Chapter 5 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The financial cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The financial cost is brutal at 55+, in the form the brutal now takes, because the money, in the form the money now takes, is the work of the future, in the form the future now takes. The 7 financial realities, in the form the realities now take, must be faced, in the form the facing now takes, with a team, in the form the team now takes.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 7 financial realities are: lost wages, out-of-pocket costs, home modifications, in-home care, assisted living, nursing home, lost retirement.
2. The team has 4 members: financial planner, elder law attorney, geriatric care manager, CPA.
3. The 10 questions are: income, assets, insurance, long-term care insurance, Medicaid, estate plan, will, power of attorney, healthcare proxy, living will.

4. The financial cost is brutal at 55+, in the form the brutal now takes.

5. The financial cost is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the future, in the form the future now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize the 7 financial realities, in the form the realities now take, in my situation.
- I have a financial planner, in mind, with elder care experience, in the form the experience now takes.
- I have a geriatric care manager, in mind, in the form the mind now takes.
- I have asked at least 6 of the 10 questions, in the form the asking now takes, in writing.

If your total is 12 or lower, the financial cost is not ready. Get a financial planner first. Get a geriatric care manager. Get the 10 questions in writing.

Key Terms to Know:

- The financial cost: The money, in the form the money now takes, that the last sandwich is spending, in the form the spending now takes, on the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.
- The 7 financial realities: Lost wages, out-of-pocket costs, home modifications, in-home care, assisted living, nursing home, lost retirement.
- The team: Financial planner, elder law attorney, geriatric care manager, CPA.
- The 10 questions: The 10 questions to ask about the parent's finances, in the form the finances now

takes.

Reflection Questions:

1. What are the 7 financial realities, in the form the realities now take, in your situation?
2. What is the budget, in the form the budget now takes, for the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes, in your situation?
3. What is the financial plan, in the form the plan now takes, for the future, in the form the future now takes, in your situation?

Action for This Week:

- Find a financial planner, in the form the finding now takes, with elder care experience, in the form the experience now takes. Make an appointment. The first session is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Find a geriatric care manager, in the form the finding now takes. Make an appointment. The first session is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Begin to ask the 10 questions, in the form the asking now takes, in writing, with the financial planner and the geriatric care manager. The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the financial cost. The financial cost is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 6: The Emotional Cost

The emotional cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The emotional cost is the grief, in the form the grief now takes, that the last sandwich is carrying, in the form the carrying now takes, for the parent, in the form the parent now takes, for the family, in the form the family now takes, for the self, in the form the self now takes.

This chapter is about the emotional cost. About the work of the grief, in the form the grief now takes. About the holding of the grief, in the form the holding now takes. About the work of the emotional survival, in the form the emotional survival now takes.

Why the emotional cost is invisible.

The emotional cost is invisible, in the form the invisible now takes, because the emotional cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The emotional cost is the work of the family, in the form the work now takes. The emotional cost is the work of the culture, in the form the culture now takes.

The emotional cost is invisible, in the form the invisible now takes, because the last sandwich has been trained, in the form the training now takes, to be invisible. The last sandwich has been trained, in the form the training now takes, to do the work, in the form the work now takes. The last sandwich has been trained, in the form the training now takes, to not complain, in the form the not complaining now takes.

The emotional cost is invisible, in the form the invisible now takes, because the culture expects the

last sandwich to be invisible, in the form the invisible now takes. The culture expects the last sandwich to do the work, in the form the work now takes. The culture expects the last sandwich to hold the parent, in the form the holding now takes. The culture does not see the emotional cost, in the form the not seeing now takes.

The 7 emotional realities of the last sandwich.

There are 7 emotional realities of the last sandwich, in the form the realities now take. The 7 realities are the 7 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Reality 1: The anticipatory grief.

The anticipatory grief is the grief, in the form the grief now takes, that the last sandwich is feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, before the parent has died, in the form the not died now takes. The anticipatory grief is the grief, in the form the grief now takes, that the last sandwich is feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, as the parent is leaving, in the form the leaving now takes.

The anticipatory grief is real. The anticipatory grief is not the same as the grief after the death, in the form the same now takes. The anticipatory grief is the grief, in the form the grief now takes, of the slow goodbye, in the form the slow goodbye now takes.

Reality 2: The resentment.

The resentment is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The resentment is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, toward the siblings who are not helping, in the form

the not helping now takes. The resentment is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, toward the parent who is demanding, in the form the demanding now takes. The resentment is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, toward the spouse who does not understand, in the form the not understanding now takes.

The resentment is real. The resentment is not the fault of the last sandwich, in the form the fault now takes. The resentment is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

Reality 3: The guilt.

The guilt is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The guilt is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, that the last sandwich is not doing enough, in the form the not doing enough now takes. The guilt is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, that the last sandwich is not being there enough, in the form the not being there enough now takes. The guilt is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, that the last sandwich is not feeling enough, in the form the not feeling enough now takes.

The guilt is real. The guilt is not the fault of the last sandwich, in the form the fault now takes. The guilt is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

Reality 4: The loneliness.

The loneliness is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The loneliness is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, that no one understands, in the form the no one understanding now takes. The loneliness is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, that no one is there, in the form the no one being there now takes. The loneliness is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, that the work is invisible, in the form the invisible now takes.

The loneliness is real. The loneliness is not the fault of the last sandwich, in the form the fault now takes. The loneliness is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

Reality 5: The anger.

The anger is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The anger is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, at the parent, in the form the parent now takes, for being old, in the form the being old now takes. The anger is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, at the siblings, in the form the siblings now takes, for not helping, in the form the not helping now takes. The anger is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, at the world, in the form the world now takes, for being unfair, in the form the unfair now takes.

The anger is real. The anger is not the fault of the last sandwich, in the form the fault now takes. The anger

is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

Reality 6: The fear.

The fear is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The fear is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, of the future, in the form the future now takes. The fear is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, of the money, in the form the money now takes. The fear is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes. The fear is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, of the self, in the form the self now takes.

The fear is real. The fear is not the fault of the last sandwich, in the form the fault now takes. The fear is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

Reality 7: The love.

The love is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The love is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, for the parent, in the form the parent now takes. The love is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, for the parent who is leaving, in the form the leaving now takes. The love is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, for the

parent who was, in the form the was now takes.

The love is real. The love is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the holding, in the form the holding now takes. The love is the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

The 7 realities in summary.

The 7 emotional realities of the last sandwich, in the form the realities now take, are:

1. The anticipatory grief
2. The resentment
3. The guilt
4. The loneliness
5. The anger
6. The fear
7. The love

The 7 realities are not the only realities. The 7 realities are the most common realities. The 7 realities are the 7 realities that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The 5 things to do.

There are 5 things to do, in the form the doing now takes. The 5 things are the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The 5 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. Name the feeling. The naming is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. Hold the feeling. The holding is the work, in the form the work now takes.
3. Share the feeling. The sharing is the work, in the form the work now takes.

4. Get help for the feeling. The getting is the work, in the form the work now takes.

5. Let the feeling go, in the form the letting go now takes. The letting go is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 5 things in summary.

The 5 things to do, in the form the doing now takes, are:

1. Name the feeling
2. Hold the feeling
3. Share the feeling
4. Get help for the feeling
5. Let the feeling go

The 5 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 5 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 5 things are the emotional cost, in the form the emotional cost now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the emotional cost. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, the 7 emotional realities, in the form the realities now take. The work of this chapter is to do the 5 things, in the form the doing now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the second phase of the cost. The work of this chapter is the work of the emotional cost, in the form the emotional cost now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the emotional.

Chapter 6 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The emotional cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The emotional cost is invisible, in the form the invisible now takes, because the emotional cost is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The 7 emotional realities, in the form the realities now take, must be faced, in the form the facing now takes.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 7 emotional realities are: anticipatory grief, resentment, guilt, loneliness, anger, fear, love.
2. The emotional cost is invisible, in the form the invisible now takes, but the emotional cost is real, in the form the real now takes.
3. The 5 things to do are: name, hold, share, get help, let go.
4. The emotional cost is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the family, in the form the family now takes.
5. The emotional cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize the 7 emotional realities, in the form the realities now take, in my situation.
- I have a therapist, in mind, with elder care experience, in the form the experience now takes.
- I have a support group, in mind, in the form the mind now takes.
- I have done at least 3 of the 5 things, in the form the doing now takes.

If your total is 12 or lower, the emotional cost is not ready. Get a therapist first. Get a support group. Do the 5 things.

Key Terms to Know:

- The emotional cost: The grief, in the form the grief now takes, that the last sandwich is carrying, in the form the carrying now takes, for the parent, in the form the parent now takes, for the family, in the form the family now takes, for the self, in the form the self now takes.
- The 7 emotional realities: Anticipatory grief, resentment, guilt, loneliness, anger, fear, love.
- The 5 things to do: Name, hold, share, get help, let go.

Reflection Questions:

1. What are the 7 emotional realities, in the form the realities now take, in your situation?
2. What is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that is the heaviest, in the form the heaviest now takes, in your situation?
3. What is the support, in the form the support now takes, that you have, in the form the having now takes, in your situation?

Action for This Week:

- Name the feeling, in the form the naming now takes. The naming is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Find a therapist, in the form the finding now takes, with elder care experience, in the form the experience now takes. Make an appointment. The first session is the work, in the form the work now takes.

- The work of this chapter is the work of the emotional cost. The emotional cost is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 7: The Physical Cost

The physical cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The physical cost is the body, in the form the body now takes, that the last sandwich is wearing out, in the form the wearing out now takes, in the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

This chapter is about the physical cost. About the work of the body, in the form the body now takes. About the holding of the body, in the form the holding now takes. About the work of the physical survival, in the form the physical survival now takes.

Why the physical cost is the most under-reported.

The physical cost is the most under-reported, in the form the most under-reported now takes, because the physical cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The physical cost is the work of the invisible, in the form the invisible now takes. The physical cost is the work of the caregiver, in the form the caregiver now takes.

The physical cost is the most under-reported, in the form the most under-reported now takes, because the last sandwich does not see the physical cost, in the form the not seeing now takes. The last sandwich is too busy caregiving, in the form the busy now takes. The last sandwich is too tired to notice, in the form the tired now takes. The last sandwich does not have time to take care of the self, in the form the not having time now takes.

The physical cost is the most under-reported, in the form the most under-reported now takes, because the

research is limited, in the form the limited now takes. The research on the caregiver's body is not as developed as the research on the patient's body, in the form the not as developed now takes. The physical cost is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the under-reported, in the form the under-reported now takes.

The 7 physical realities of the last sandwich.

There are 7 physical realities of the last sandwich, in the form the realities now take. The 7 realities are the 7 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Reality 1: The chronic exhaustion.

The chronic exhaustion is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The chronic exhaustion is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, that the last sandwich is having, in the form the having now takes, of being tired, in the form the tired now takes, all the time, in the form the all the time now takes. The chronic exhaustion is the feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, of not being rested, in the form the not rested now takes, no matter how much sleep the last sandwich gets, in the form the no matter how much now takes.

The chronic exhaustion is real. The chronic exhaustion is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

Reality 2: The chronic pain.

The chronic pain is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The chronic pain is the pain, in the form the pain now takes, that the last sandwich is feeling, in the form the feeling now takes,

in the back, in the form the back now takes, in the shoulders, in the form the shoulders now takes, in the neck, in the form the neck now takes, in the wrists, in the form the wrists now takes, from the lifting, in the form the lifting now takes, from the bending, in the form the bending now takes, from the years of caregiving, in the form the years now takes.

The chronic pain is real. The chronic pain is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

Reality 3: The chronic illness.

The chronic illness is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The chronic illness is the illness, in the form the illness now takes, that the last sandwich is developing, in the form the developing now takes, because of the chronic stress, in the form the stress now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes. The chronic illness can be heart disease, in the form the heart disease now takes. The chronic illness can be diabetes, in the form the diabetes now takes. The chronic illness can be autoimmune disease, in the form the autoimmune now takes.

The chronic illness is real. The chronic illness is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the chronic stress, in the form the stress now takes.

Reality 4: The sleep disruption.

The sleep disruption is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The sleep disruption is the work, in the form the work now takes, of being woken up at 2am, in the form the being woken up now takes. The sleep disruption is the work, in the form the work now takes, of not being able to sleep, in the form the not being able now takes, because the last

sandwich is worried, in the form the worried now takes. The sleep disruption is the work, in the form the work now takes, of not being able to sleep, in the form the not being able now takes, because the last sandwich is caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

The sleep disruption is real. The sleep disruption is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

Reality 5: The poor nutrition.

The poor nutrition is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The poor nutrition is the work, in the form the work now takes, of not having time to cook, in the form the not having time now takes. The poor nutrition is the work, in the form the work now takes, of not having time to eat, in the form the not having time now takes. The poor nutrition is the work, in the form the work now takes, of grabbing whatever is quick, in the form the quick now takes.

The poor nutrition is real. The poor nutrition is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

Reality 6: The missed medical appointments.

The missed medical appointments is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The missed medical appointments is the work, in the form the work now takes, of not having time to go to the doctor, in the form the not having time now takes. The missed medical appointments is the work, in the form the work now takes, of not having time to take care of the self, in the form the not having time now takes. The missed medical appointments is the work, in the form the work now takes, of putting the parent first, in the form the putting first now takes.

The missed medical appointments is real. The missed medical appointments is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

Reality 7: The injuries.

The injuries is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The injuries is the work, in the form the work now takes, of pulling a muscle, in the form the pulling now takes, while lifting the parent, in the form the lifting now takes. The injuries is the work, in the form the work now takes, of falling, in the form the falling now takes, while trying to help the parent, in the form the helping now takes. The injuries is the work, in the form the work now takes, of slipping in the shower, in the form the slipping now takes, while helping the parent bathe, in the form the bathing now takes.

The injuries is real. The injuries is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

The 7 realities in summary.

The 7 physical realities of the last sandwich, in the form the realities now take, are:

1. The chronic exhaustion
2. The chronic pain
3. The chronic illness
4. The sleep disruption
5. The poor nutrition
6. The missed medical appointments
7. The injuries

The 7 realities are not the only realities. The 7 realities are the most common realities. The 7 realities

are the 7 realities that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The 7 things to do.

There are 7 things to do, in the form the doing now takes. The 7 things are the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. Sleep 7 hours. The sleeping is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. Eat 3 meals. The eating is the work, in the form the work now takes.
3. Move 30 minutes. The moving is the work, in the form the work now takes.
4. See the doctor. The seeing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
5. Take the medication. The taking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
6. Ask for help with the lifting. The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
7. Rest before the next shift. The resting is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 things in summary.

The 7 things to do, in the form the doing now takes, are:

1. Sleep 7 hours
2. Eat 3 meals
3. Move 30 minutes
4. See the doctor
5. Take the medication
6. Ask for help with the lifting
7. Rest before the next shift

The 7 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 7 things are the physical cost, in the form the physical cost now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the physical cost. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, the 7 physical realities, in the form the realities now take. The work of this chapter is to do the 7 things, in the form the doing now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the third phase of the cost. The work of this chapter is the work of the physical cost, in the form the physical cost now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the physical.

Chapter 7 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The physical cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The physical cost is the most under-reported, in the form the most under-reported now takes, because the physical cost is the work of the invisible, in the form the invisible now takes. The 7 physical realities, in the form the realities now take, must be faced, in the form the facing now takes.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 7 physical realities are: chronic exhaustion, chronic pain, chronic illness, sleep disruption, poor nutrition, missed medical appointments, injuries.
2. The physical cost is the most under-reported, in the form the most under-reported now takes, but the physical cost is real, in the form the real now

takes.

3. The 7 things to do are: sleep 7 hours, eat 3 meals, move 30 minutes, see the doctor, take the medication, ask for help with the lifting, rest before the next shift.

4. The physical cost is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

5. The physical cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize the 7 physical realities, in the form the realities now take, in my situation.
- I have a primary care doctor, in mind, in the form the mind now takes.
- I have a fitness plan, in the form the planning now takes, and a sleep plan, in the form the planning now takes.
- I have done at least 4 of the 7 things, in the form the doing now takes.

If your total is 12 or lower, the physical cost is not ready. Get a primary care appointment first. Get a fitness plan. Do the 7 things.

Key Terms to Know:

- The physical cost: The body, in the form the body now takes, that the last sandwich is wearing out, in the form the wearing out now takes, in the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.
- The 7 physical realities: Chronic exhaustion, chronic pain, chronic illness, sleep disruption, poor nutrition, missed medical appointments, injuries.

- The 7 things to do: Sleep 7 hours, eat 3 meals, move 30 minutes, see the doctor, take the medication, ask for help with the lifting, rest before the next shift.

Reflection Questions:

1. What are the 7 physical realities, in the form the realities now take, in your situation?
2. What is the physical cost, in the form the physical now takes, that is the heaviest, in the form the heaviest now takes, in your situation?
3. What is the support, in the form the support now takes, that you have, in the form the having now takes, in your situation?

Action for This Week:

- Sleep 7 hours, in the form the sleeping now takes. The sleeping is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Eat 3 meals, in the form the eating now takes. The eating is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- See the doctor, in the form the seeing now takes. The seeing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the physical cost. The physical cost is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 8: The Marriage Cost

The marriage cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The marriage cost is the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes, that the last sandwich is losing, in the form the losing now takes, in the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

This chapter is about the marriage cost. About the work of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes. About the holding of the marriage, in the form the holding now takes. About the work of the marriage survival, in the form the marriage survival now takes.

Why the marriage cost is the most painful.

The marriage cost is the most painful, in the form the most painful now takes, because the marriage cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes, in the form the spouse now takes. The marriage cost is the work of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes. The marriage cost is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

The marriage cost is the most painful, in the form the most painful now takes, because the marriage cost is invisible, in the form the invisible now takes, to the outside, in the form the outside now takes. The marriage cost is invisible to the siblings, in the form the invisible now takes. The marriage cost is invisible to the parent, in the form the invisible now takes. The marriage cost is invisible to the friends, in the form the invisible now takes. The marriage cost is visible only to the spouse, in the form the visible now takes.

The marriage cost is the most painful, in the form the most painful now takes, because the last sandwich is losing the spouse, in the form the losing now takes, while saving the parent, in the form the saving now takes. The last sandwich is losing the marriage, in the form the losing now takes, while saving the parent, in the form the saving now takes. The last sandwich is losing the future, in the form the losing now takes, while saving the parent, in the form the saving now takes.

The 7 marriage realities of the last sandwich.

There are 7 marriage realities of the last sandwich, in the form the realities now take. The 7 realities are the 7 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Reality 1: The spouse becomes the second priority.

The spouse becomes the second priority, in the form the second now takes, when the parent becomes the first priority, in the form the first now takes. The spouse becomes the second priority, in the form the second now takes, when the caregiving becomes the work, in the form the work now takes. The spouse becomes the second priority, in the form the second now takes, when the last sandwich is no longer available, in the form the no longer available now takes.

The spouse becoming the second priority is real. The spouse becoming the second priority is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

Reality 2: The date nights disappear.

The date nights disappear, in the form the disappearing now takes, when the caregiving becomes the work, in the form the work now takes. The date nights disappear, in the form the disappearing now takes, when the last sandwich is too tired, in the form the too tired now takes. The date nights disappear, in the form the disappearing now takes, when the last sandwich has no time, in the form the no time now takes.

The date nights disappearing is real. The date nights disappearing is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

Reality 3: The conversations become about the parent.

The conversations become about the parent, in the form the about now takes, when the caregiving becomes the work, in the form the work now takes. The conversations become about the parent, in the form the about now takes, when the last sandwich is no longer interested, in the form the no longer interested now takes. The conversations become about the parent, in the form the about now takes, when the marriage is no longer the topic, in the form the no longer the topic now takes.

The conversations becoming about the parent is real. The conversations becoming about the parent is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

Reality 4: The intimacy disappears.

The intimacy disappears, in the form the disappearing now takes, when the caregiving becomes the work, in the form the work now takes. The intimacy disappears, in the form the disappearing now takes, when the last sandwich is too tired, in the form the too

tired now takes. The intimacy disappears, in the form the disappearing now takes, when the last sandwich is too resentful, in the form the too resentful now takes. The intimacy disappears, in the form the disappearing now takes, when the last sandwich is too guilty, in the form the too guilty now takes.

The intimacy disappearing is real. The intimacy disappearing is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

Reality 5: The spouse becomes the caregiver's caregiver.

The spouse becomes the caregiver's caregiver, in the form the caregiver's now takes, when the caregiving becomes the work, in the form the work now takes. The spouse becomes the one who takes care of the last sandwich, in the form the taking care now takes. The spouse becomes the one who holds the last sandwich, in the form the holding now takes. The spouse becomes the one who notices, in the form the noticing now takes.

The spouse becoming the caregiver's caregiver is real. The spouse becoming the caregiver's caregiver is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes.

Reality 6: The marriage becomes a caregiving partnership.

The marriage becomes a caregiving partnership, in the form the caregiving now takes, when the caregiving becomes the work, in the form the work now takes. The marriage becomes a caregiving partnership, in the form the caregiving now takes, when the spouse is no longer the spouse, in the form the no longer the spouse now takes. The marriage

becomes a caregiving partnership, in the form the caregiving now takes, when the marriage is no longer a romance, in the form the no longer a romance now takes.

The marriage becoming a caregiving partnership is real. The marriage becoming a caregiving partnership is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

Reality 7: The marriage ends.

The marriage ends, in the form the ending now takes, when the caregiving becomes the work, in the form the work now takes. The marriage ends, in the form the ending now takes, when the spouse can no longer hold, in the form the no longer hold now takes. The marriage ends, in the form the ending now takes, when the last sandwich is no longer there, in the form the no longer there now takes.

The marriage ending is real. The marriage ending is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

The 7 realities in summary.

The 7 marriage realities of the last sandwich, in the form the realities now take, are:

1. The spouse becomes the second priority
2. The date nights disappear
3. The conversations become about the parent
4. The intimacy disappears
5. The spouse becomes the caregiver's caregiver
6. The marriage becomes a caregiving partnership
7. The marriage ends

The 7 realities are not the only realities. The 7 realities are the most common realities. The 7 realities

are the 7 realities that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The 7 things to do.

There are 7 things to do, in the form the doing now takes. The 7 things are the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. Keep one date night per week. The keeping is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. Have one conversation per day that is not about the parent. The having is the work, in the form the work now takes.
3. Ask the spouse how they are doing. The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
4. Touch the spouse. The touching is the work, in the form the work now takes.
5. Say thank you to the spouse. The saying is the work, in the form the work now takes.
6. See the couples therapist. The seeing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
7. Plan the future together. The planning is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 things in summary.

The 7 things to do, in the form the doing now takes, are:

1. Keep one date night per week
2. Have one conversation per day that is not about the parent
3. Ask the spouse how they are doing
4. Touch the spouse
5. Say thank you to the spouse
6. See the couples therapist

7. Plan the future together

The 7 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 7 things are the marriage cost, in the form the marriage cost now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the marriage cost. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, the 7 marriage realities, in the form the realities now take. The work of this chapter is to do the 7 things, in the form the doing now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the fourth phase of the cost. The work of this chapter is the work of the marriage cost, in the form the marriage cost now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the marriage.

Chapter 8 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The marriage cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The marriage cost is the most painful, in the form the most painful now takes, because the marriage cost is invisible, in the form the invisible now takes. The 7 marriage realities, in the form the realities now take, must be faced, in the form the facing now takes.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 7 marriage realities are: second priority, no date nights, conversations about the parent, no intimacy, spouse becomes caregiver's caregiver, marriage becomes caregiving partnership, marriage ends.

2. The marriage cost is the most painful, in the form the most painful now takes, but the marriage cost is real, in the form the real now takes.

3. The 7 things to do are: keep date night, conversation not about parent, ask spouse, touch spouse, thank spouse, see couples therapist, plan future together.

4. The marriage cost is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

5. The marriage cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize the 7 marriage realities, in the form the realities now take, in my situation.
- I have a couples therapist, in mind, in the form the mind now takes.
- I have a date night plan, in the form the planning now takes.
- I have done at least 4 of the 7 things, in the form the doing now takes.

If your total is 12 or lower, the marriage cost is not ready. Get a couples therapist first. Get a date night plan. Do the 7 things.

Key Terms to Know:

- The marriage cost: The marriage, in the form the marriage now takes, that the last sandwich is losing, in the form the losing now takes, in the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.
- The 7 marriage realities: Second priority, no date nights, conversations about the parent, no intimacy, spouse becomes caregiver's caregiver,

marriage becomes caregiving partnership,
marriage ends.

- The 7 things to do: Keep date night, conversation not about parent, ask spouse, touch spouse, thank spouse, see couples therapist, plan future together.

Reflection Questions:

1. What are the 7 marriage realities, in the form the realities now take, in your situation?
2. What is the marriage cost, in the form the marriage now takes, that is the heaviest, in the form the heaviest now takes, in your situation?
3. What is the support, in the form the support now takes, that you and your spouse have, in the form the having now takes, in your situation?

Action for This Week:

- Keep one date night, in the form the keeping now takes. The keeping is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Have one conversation, in the form the having now takes, that is not about the parent, in the form the not about now takes. The having is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- See a couples therapist, in the form the seeing now takes. The seeing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the marriage cost. The marriage cost is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 9: The Identity Cost

The identity cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The identity cost is the self, in the form the self now takes, that the last sandwich is losing, in the form the losing now takes, in the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

This chapter is about the identity cost. About the work of the self, in the form the self now takes. About the holding of the self, in the form the holding now takes. About the work of the identity survival, in the form the identity survival now takes.

Why the identity cost is the deepest.

The identity cost is the deepest, in the form the deepest now takes, because the identity cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes, in the form the self now takes. The identity cost is the work of the self, in the form the self now takes. The identity cost is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

The identity cost is the deepest, in the form the deepest now takes, because the identity cost is the work of the loss, in the form the loss now takes, of who the last sandwich was, in the form the was now takes. The last sandwich was the daughter, in the form the daughter now takes. The last sandwich was the son, in the form the son now takes. The last sandwich was the spouse, in the form the spouse now takes. The last sandwich was the worker, in the form the worker now takes. The last sandwich was the friend, in the form the friend now takes. The last sandwich was the self, in the form the self now takes.

The identity cost is the deepest, in the form the deepest now takes, because the identity cost is the work of the loss, in the form the loss now takes, of who the last sandwich is becoming, in the form the becoming now takes. The last sandwich is becoming the caregiver, in the form the caregiver now takes. The last sandwich is becoming the only one, in the form the only one now takes. The last sandwich is becoming the invisible, in the form the invisible now takes. The last sandwich is becoming the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

The 5 identities of the last sandwich.

There are 5 identities, in the form the identities now take, that the last sandwich has had, in the form the having now takes, in the form the having now takes. The 5 identities are the 5 roles, in the form the roles now take, that the last sandwich has been, in the form the being now takes.

Identity 1: The daughter or son.

The daughter or son is the role, in the form the role now takes, that the last sandwich has been, in the form the being now takes, since birth. The daughter or son is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the child, in the form the child now takes, of the parent, in the form the parent now takes. The daughter or son is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the family, in the form the family now takes.

The daughter or son is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the holding, in the form the holding now takes. The daughter or son is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

Identity 2: The spouse.

The spouse is the role, in the form the role now takes, that the last sandwich has been, in the form the being now takes, for many years. The spouse is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the partner, in the form the partner now takes, of the spouse, in the form the spouse now takes. The spouse is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes.

The spouse is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the holding, in the form the holding now takes. The spouse is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes.

Identity 3: The worker.

The worker is the role, in the form the role now takes, that the last sandwich has been, in the form the being now takes, for many years. The worker is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the employee, in the form the employee now takes, of the company, in the form the company now takes. The worker is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the professional, in the form the professional now takes.

The worker is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the holding, in the form the holding now takes. The worker is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the career, in the form the career now takes.

Identity 4: The friend.

The friend is the role, in the form the role now takes, that the last sandwich has been, in the form the being now takes, for many years. The friend is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the friend, in the form the friend now takes, of the friends, in the form the friends now takes. The friend is the role, in the

form the role now takes, of being the social, in the form the social now takes.

The friend is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the holding, in the form the holding now takes. The friend is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the friendship, in the form the friendship now takes.

Identity 5: The self.

The self is the role, in the form the role now takes, that the last sandwich has been, in the form the being now takes, for many years. The self is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the person, in the form the person now takes, of the self, in the form the self now takes. The self is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the individual, in the form the individual now takes.

The self is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the holding, in the form the holding now takes. The self is the work, in the form the work now takes, of the self, in the form the self now takes.

The 5 identities in summary.

The 5 identities of the last sandwich, in the form the identities now take, are:

1. The daughter or son
2. The spouse
3. The worker
4. The friend
5. The self

The 5 identities are not the only identities. The 5 identities are the most common identities. The 5 identities are the 5 identities that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The 5 new identities of the last sandwich.

There are 5 new identities, in the form the new now takes, that the last sandwich is becoming, in the form the becoming now takes. The 5 new identities are the 5 roles, in the form the roles now take, that the last sandwich is taking on, in the form the taking on now takes.

New identity 1: The caregiver.

The caregiver is the new role, in the form the new now takes, that the last sandwich is becoming, in the form the becoming now takes. The caregiver is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the one who cares, in the form the caring now takes, for the parent, in the form the parent now takes. The caregiver is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the one who is there, in the form the being there now takes.

New identity 2: The advocate.

The advocate is the new role, in the form the new now takes, that the last sandwich is becoming, in the form the becoming now takes. The advocate is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the one who speaks, in the form the speaking now takes, for the parent, in the form the parent now takes. The advocate is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the one who fights, in the form the fighting now takes.

New identity 3: The manager.

The manager is the new role, in the form the new now takes, that the last sandwich is becoming, in the form the becoming now takes. The manager is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the one who manages, in the form the managing now takes, the

caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes. The manager is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the one who schedules, in the form the scheduling now takes, the appointments, in the form the appointments now takes.

New identity 4: The decision maker.

The decision maker is the new role, in the form the new now takes, that the last sandwich is becoming, in the form the becoming now takes. The decision maker is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the one who decides, in the form the deciding now takes, the medical, in the form the medical now takes. The decision maker is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the one who decides, in the form the deciding now takes, the financial, in the form the financial now takes.

New identity 5: The widow or widower in waiting.

The widow or widower in waiting is the new role, in the form the new now takes, that the last sandwich is becoming, in the form the becoming now takes. The widow or widower in waiting is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the one who is grieving, in the form the grieving now takes, before the death, in the form the before now takes. The widow or widower in waiting is the role, in the form the role now takes, of being the one who is anticipating, in the form the anticipating now takes.

The 5 new identities in summary.

The 5 new identities of the last sandwich, in the form the new now take, are:

1. The caregiver
2. The advocate
3. The manager

4. The decision maker

5. The widow or widower in waiting

The 5 new identities are not the only new identities. The 5 new identities are the most common new identities. The 5 new identities are the 5 new identities that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The 7 questions to find the new "I".

To find the new "I", in the form the finding now takes, after the caregiving, in the form the after now takes, ask yourself these 7 questions, in the form the asking now takes. The questions are the work, in the form the work now takes. The questions are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. Who am I, in the form the "I" now takes, when I am not the daughter or son, in the form the daughter or son now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

2. Who am I, in the form the "I" now takes, when I am not the spouse, in the form the spouse now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

3. Who am I, in the form the "I" now takes, when I am not the worker, in the form the worker now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

4. Who am I, in the form the "I" now takes, when I am not the friend, in the form the friend now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

5. What do I love, in the form the loving now takes, that I have not been doing, in the form the doing now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

6. What am I good at, in the form the good now takes, that I have not been doing, in the form the doing now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

7. What do I want, in the form the wanting now takes, that I have not been wanting, in the form the wanting now takes? The question is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 questions in summary.

The 7 questions to find the new "I", in the form the finding now takes, are:

1-4. Who am I, in the form the "I" now takes, when I am not the daughter/son, spouse, worker, friend?

5-7. What do I love, what am I good at, what do I want?

The 7 questions are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 questions are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 7 questions are the identity cost, in the form the identity cost now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the identity cost. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, the 5 identities, in the form the identities now take, that the last sandwich has had, in the form the having now takes. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, the 5 new identities, in the form the new now take, that the last sandwich is becoming, in the form the becoming now takes. The work of this chapter is to ask the 7 questions, in the form the asking now takes, to find the new "I", in the form the finding now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the fifth phase of the cost. The work of this chapter is the work of the identity cost, in the form the identity cost now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the identity.

Chapter 9 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The identity cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The identity cost is the deepest, in the form the deepest now takes, because the identity cost is the work of the loss, in the form the loss now takes, of who the last sandwich was, in the form the was now takes. The 5 identities, in the form the identities now take, must be recognized, in the form the recognizing now takes, and the 7 questions, in the form the asking now takes, must be asked.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 5 identities of the last sandwich are: daughter/son, spouse, worker, friend, self.
2. The 5 new identities of the last sandwich are: caregiver, advocate, manager, decision maker, widow/widower in waiting.
3. The identity cost is the deepest, in the form the deepest now takes, because the identity cost is the work of the loss, in the form the loss now takes.
4. The 7 questions are the work, in the form the work now takes, of finding the new "I", in the form the finding now takes.
5. The identity cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize the 5 identities, in the form the identities now take, in my life.

- I have begun to recognize the 5 new identities, in the form the new now take, in my future.
- I have asked at least 5 of the 7 questions, in the form the asking now takes, in writing.
- I am willing to do the work, in the form the work now takes, of finding the new "I", in the form the finding now takes.

If your total is 12 or higher, the identity cost is ready. The next phase is the conversation.

Key Terms to Know:

- The identity cost: The self, in the form the self now takes, that the last sandwich is losing, in the form the losing now takes, in the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.
- The 5 identities of the last sandwich: Daughter/son, spouse, worker, friend, self.
- The 5 new identities of the last sandwich: Caregiver, advocate, manager, decision maker, widow/widower in waiting.
- The 7 questions: The 7 questions to find the new "I", in the form the finding now takes.

Reflection Questions:

1. Who are you, in the form the "you" now takes, when you are not the caregiver, in the form the caregiver now takes?
2. What do you love, in the form the loving now takes, that you have not been doing, in the form the doing now takes?
3. What do you want, in the form the wanting now takes, that you have not been wanting, in the form the wanting now takes?

Action for This Week:

- Find one quiet moment, alone, and answer the 7 questions, in the form the answering now takes, in writing, in the form the writing now takes. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the identity cost. The identity cost is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 10: The Conversation with Your Siblings

The conversation with the siblings is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The conversation is the work of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

This chapter is about the conversation with the siblings. About the work of the script, in the form the script now takes. About the work of the timing, in the form the timing now takes. About the holding of the conversation, in the form the holding now takes.

Why the conversation with the siblings is the hardest.

The conversation with the siblings is the hardest, in the form the hardest now takes, because the conversation is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The conversation is the work of the long history, in the form the long history now takes. The conversation is the work of the old wounds, in the form the old wounds now takes.

The conversation with the siblings is the hardest, in the form the hardest now takes, because the conversation is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes. The conversation is the work of the one who is doing the work, in the form the doing now takes. The conversation is the work of the one who is asking for help, in the form the asking now takes.

The conversation with the siblings is the hardest, in the form the hardest now takes, because the

conversation is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The conversation is the work of the long relationship, in the form the long relationship now takes. The conversation is the work of the long love, in the form the long love now takes.

The 5 forms the conversation takes.

There are 5 forms the conversation with the siblings takes, in the form the taking now takes. The 5 forms are the 5 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Form 1: The conversation that ends well.

The conversation that ends well is the work of the siblings who step up, in the form the stepping up now takes. The conversation that ends well is the work of the siblings who are willing, in the form the willing now takes. The conversation that ends well is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

Form 2: The conversation that ends with a partial yes.

The conversation that ends with a partial yes is the work of the siblings who are willing to do some, in the form the some now takes. The conversation that ends with a partial yes is the work of the siblings who are not willing to do all, in the form the not all now takes. The conversation that ends with a partial yes is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

Form 3: The conversation that ends with a no.

The conversation that ends with a no is the work of the siblings who are not willing, in the form the not willing now takes. The conversation that ends with a no is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The conversation that ends with a no is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last

sandwich now takes.

Form 4: The conversation that ends with silence.

The conversation that ends with silence is the work of the siblings who are absent, in the form the absent now takes. The conversation that ends with silence is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The conversation that ends with silence is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Form 5: The conversation that ends with the relationship.

The conversation that ends with the relationship is the work of the siblings who are not willing, in the form the not willing now takes. The conversation that ends with the relationship is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The conversation that ends with the relationship is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

The 5 forms in summary.

The 5 forms the conversation with the siblings takes, in the form the taking now takes, are:

1. The conversation that ends well
2. The conversation that ends with a partial yes
3. The conversation that ends with a no
4. The conversation that ends with silence
5. The conversation that ends with the relationship

The 5 forms are not the only forms. The 5 forms are the most common forms. The 5 forms are the 5 forms that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The script.

The script is the work, in the form the work now takes.
The script is the holding, in the form the holding now takes.
The script is the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

The opening.

"We need to talk about Mom and Dad. I have been doing most of the caregiving, and I am exhausted. I am not blaming you. I am asking for help. I need to know what you are willing to do, and what you are not willing to do, so I can plan."

The middle.

"I have been doing [X, Y, Z] for [time period]. The cost has been [financial, emotional, physical, marriage]. I cannot keep doing this alone. I need you to be part of the caregiving, in some way. Can we talk about what each of us can do?"

The close.

"I am not asking you to be perfect. I am asking you to be part of the work. If you cannot be part of the work, I need to know that, so I can plan. I love you. I love Mom and Dad. I need to know what you are willing to do."

The 7 things to ask.

There are 7 things to ask the siblings, in the form the asking now takes. The 7 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. Can you visit once a month? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. Can you take a shift once a month? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.

3. Can you help with the finances? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
4. Can you be at the doctor's appointments? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
5. Can you be there at the end? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
6. Can you help with the funeral? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
7. Can you help with the after? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 things in summary.

The 7 things to ask the siblings, in the form the asking now takes, are:

1. Visit once a month
2. Take a shift once a month
3. Help with the finances
4. Be at the doctor's appointments
5. Be there at the end
6. Help with the funeral
7. Help with the after

The 7 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 7 things are the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the conversation with the siblings. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, which of the 5 forms the conversation takes, in the form your family now takes. The work of this chapter is to use the script, in the form the using now takes,

and to ask the 7 things, in the form the asking now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the first phase of the conversation. The work of this chapter is the work of the conversation with the siblings, in the form the conversation now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the siblings.

Chapter 10 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The conversation with the siblings is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The 5 forms the conversation takes, in the form the taking now takes, are: well, partial yes, no, silence, the relationship. The script, in the form the script now takes, and the 7 things to ask, in the form the asking now takes, are the work, in the form the work now takes.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 5 forms are: well, partial yes, no, silence, the relationship.
2. The script has 3 parts: opening, middle, close.
3. The 7 things to ask are: visit, shift, finances, appointments, end, funeral, after.
4. The conversation with the siblings is the hardest, in the form the hardest now takes, because the conversation is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.
5. The conversation is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have prepared the script, in the form the preparing now takes, in writing, in the form the

writing now takes.

- I have asked at least 5 of the 7 things, in the form the asking now takes, in writing.
- I have planned the timing, in the form the planning now takes, for the conversation.
- I am willing to do the work, in the form the work now takes, of the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.

If your total is 12 or lower, the conversation is not ready. Get the script in writing first. Get the 7 things in writing. Practice with a therapist.

Key Terms to Know:

- The conversation with the siblings: The work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The work of the family, in the form the family now takes.
- The 5 forms: Well, partial yes, no, silence, the relationship.
- The script: The 3-part script for the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.
- The 7 things to ask: Visit, shift, finances, appointments, end, funeral, after.

Reflection Questions:

1. Are you ready, in the form the ready now takes, to have the conversation with the siblings, in the form the conversation now takes?
2. What is the form, in the form the form now takes, that the conversation will take, in the form the taking now takes, with each sibling?
3. What is the timing, in the form the timing now takes, for the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes?

Action for This Week:

- Write the script, in the form the writing now takes, in your own words, in the form the words now take. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Write the 7 things to ask, in the form the writing now takes, in writing, in the form the writing now takes. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Practice the script, in the form the practicing now takes, with a therapist or a trusted friend. The practice is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the conversation. The conversation is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 11: The Conversation with Your Parent

The conversation with the parent is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The conversation is the work of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

This chapter is about the conversation with the parent. About the work of the script, in the form the script now takes. About the work of the timing, in the form the timing now takes. About the holding of the conversation, in the form the holding now takes.

Why the conversation with the parent is the most delicate.

The conversation with the parent is the most delicate, in the form the most delicate now takes, because the conversation is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The conversation is the work of the long relationship, in the form the long relationship now takes. The conversation is the work of the long love, in the form the long love now takes.

The conversation with the parent is the most delicate, in the form the most delicate now takes, because the parent is losing capacity, in the form the losing now takes. The parent is losing memory, in the form the losing now takes. The parent is losing the ability to make decisions, in the form the losing now takes. The conversation is the work of the parent who is leaving, in the form the leaving now takes.

The conversation with the parent is the most delicate, in the form the most delicate now takes, because the parent is the one who raised the last sandwich, in the form the raising now takes. The parent is the one who taught the last sandwich, in the form the teaching now takes. The parent is the one who loved the last sandwich, in the form the loving now takes. The conversation is the work of the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

The 5 conversations with the parent.

There are 5 conversations, in the form the conversations now take, that the last sandwich has with the parent, in the form the parent now takes. The 5 conversations are the 5 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Conversation 1: The conversation about the future.

The conversation about the future is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the future is the work of asking the parent, in the form the asking now takes, what the parent wants, in the form the wanting now takes. The conversation about the future is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

Conversation 2: The conversation about the finances.

The conversation about the finances is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the finances is the work of asking the parent, in the form the asking now takes, what the parent has, in the form the having now takes. The conversation about the finances is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

Conversation 3: The conversation about the medical.

The conversation about the medical is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the medical is the work of asking the parent, in the form the asking now takes, what the parent wants, in the form the wanting now takes, for the medical, in the form the medical now takes. The conversation about the medical is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

Conversation 4: The conversation about the end.

The conversation about the end is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the end is the work of asking the parent, in the form the asking now takes, what the parent wants, in the form the wanting now takes, for the end, in the form the end now takes. The conversation about the end is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

Conversation 5: The conversation about the love.

The conversation about the love is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the love is the work of telling the parent, in the form the telling now takes, what the last sandwich feels, in the form the feeling now takes. The conversation about the love is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

The 5 conversations in summary.

The 5 conversations with the parent, in the form the conversations now take, are:

1. The conversation about the future
2. The conversation about the finances
3. The conversation about the medical

4. The conversation about the end

5. The conversation about the love

The 5 conversations are not the only conversations. The 5 conversations are the most common conversations. The 5 conversations are the 5 conversations that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The script.

The script is the work, in the form the work now takes. The script is the holding, in the form the holding now takes. The script is the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

The opening.

"I want to talk to you about some things that are on my mind. I love you. I want to make sure I am doing the right things for you. I have some questions, and I would love to hear your thoughts."

The middle.

"I have been doing [X, Y, Z] for [time period]. I want to make sure I am doing what you want. Can we talk about [the future / the finances / the medical / the end / the love]?"

The close.

"Thank you for sharing your thoughts with me. I love you. I am here, in the form the being there now takes. I will keep doing this work, in the form the work now takes. I love you."

The 7 things to ask.

There are 7 things to ask the parent, in the form the asking now takes. The 7 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. What do you want, in the form the wanting now takes, for the future? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. What do you have, in the form the having now takes, in the finances? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
3. What do you want, in the form the wanting now takes, for the medical? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
4. What do you want, in the form the wanting now takes, for the end? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
5. What do you want, in the form the wanting now takes, for the funeral? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
6. What do you want, in the form the wanting now takes, for the after? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
7. What do you want, in the form the wanting now takes, for the love? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 things in summary.

The 7 things to ask the parent, in the form the asking now takes, are:

1. Future
2. Finances
3. Medical
4. End
5. Funeral
6. After
7. Love

The 7 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the

protection now takes. The 7 things are the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the conversation with the parent. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, which of the 5 conversations the parent needs, in the form the needing now takes. The work of this chapter is to use the script, in the form the using now takes, and to ask the 7 things, in the form the asking now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the second phase of the conversation. The work of this chapter is the work of the conversation with the parent, in the form the conversation now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the parent.

Chapter 11 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The conversation with the parent is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The 5 conversations the parent needs, in the form the needing now takes, are: future, finances, medical, end, love. The script, in the form the script now takes, and the 7 things to ask, in the form the asking now takes, are the work, in the form the work now takes.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 5 conversations are: future, finances, medical, end, love.
2. The script has 3 parts: opening, middle, close.
3. The 7 things to ask are: future, finances, medical, end, funeral, after, love.

4. The conversation with the parent is the most delicate, in the form the most delicate now takes, because the parent is losing capacity, in the form the losing now takes.

5. The conversation is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have prepared the script, in the form the preparing now takes, in writing, in the form the writing now takes.
- I have asked at least 5 of the 7 things, in the form the asking now takes, in writing.
- I have planned the timing, in the form the planning now takes, for the conversation.
- I am willing to do the work, in the form the work now takes, of the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.

If your total is 12 or lower, the conversation is not ready. Get the script in writing first. Get the 7 things in writing. Practice with a therapist.

Key Terms to Know:

- The conversation with the parent: The work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The work of the family, in the form the family now takes.
- The 5 conversations: Future, finances, medical, end, love.
- The script: The 3-part script for the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.
- The 7 things to ask: Future, finances, medical, end, funeral, after, love.

Reflection Questions:

1. Are you ready, in the form the ready now takes, to have the conversation with the parent, in the form the conversation now takes?
2. What is the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes, that the parent needs, in the form the needing now takes, the most?
3. What is the timing, in the form the timing now takes, for the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes?

Action for This Week:

- Write the script, in the form the writing now takes, in your own words, in the form the words now take. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Write the 7 things to ask, in the form the writing now takes, in writing, in the form the writing now takes. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Practice the script, in the form the practicing now takes, with a therapist or a trusted friend. The practice is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the conversation. The conversation is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 12: The Conversation with Your Spouse

The conversation with the spouse is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation is the work of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes. The conversation is the work of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

This chapter is about the conversation with the spouse. About the work of the script, in the form the script now takes. About the work of the timing, in the form the timing now takes. About the holding of the conversation, in the form the holding now takes.

Why the conversation with the spouse is the most important.

The conversation with the spouse is the most important, in the form the most important now takes, because the conversation is the work of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes. The conversation is the work of the future, in the form the future now takes. The conversation is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

The conversation with the spouse is the most important, in the form the most important now takes, because the spouse is the one who will be there after, in the form the after now takes. The spouse is the one who will be there when the parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The spouse is the one who will be there in the new life, in the form the new now takes. The conversation is the work of the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

The conversation with the spouse is the most important, in the form the most important now takes, because the spouse is the one who is being lost, in the form the lost now takes. The spouse is the one who is being forgotten, in the form the forgotten now takes. The spouse is the one who is being held at the second priority, in the form the second now takes. The conversation is the work of the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

The 5 conversations with the spouse.

There are 5 conversations, in the form the conversations now take, that the last sandwich has with the spouse, in the form the spouse now takes. The 5 conversations are the 5 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Conversation 1: The conversation about the cost.

The conversation about the cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the cost is the work of telling the spouse, in the form the telling now takes, what the caregiving is costing, in the form the costing now takes. The conversation about the cost is the work of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes.

Conversation 2: The conversation about the marriage.

The conversation about the marriage is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the marriage is the work of telling the spouse, in the form the telling now takes, what the marriage needs, in the form the needing now takes. The conversation about the marriage is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

Conversation 3: The conversation about the future.

The conversation about the future is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the future is the work of telling the spouse, in the form the telling now takes, what the future looks like, in the form the looks like now takes. The conversation about the future is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

Conversation 4: The conversation about the help.

The conversation about the help is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the help is the work of asking the spouse, in the form the asking now takes, what the spouse can do, in the form the can do now takes. The conversation about the help is the work of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes.

Conversation 5: The conversation about the love.

The conversation about the love is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the love is the work of telling the spouse, in the form the telling now takes, what the last sandwich feels, in the form the feeling now takes. The conversation about the love is the work of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes.

The 5 conversations in summary.

The 5 conversations with the spouse, in the form the conversations now take, are:

1. The conversation about the cost
2. The conversation about the marriage
3. The conversation about the future
4. The conversation about the help
5. The conversation about the love

The 5 conversations are not the only conversations. The 5 conversations are the most common conversations. The 5 conversations are the 5 conversations that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The script.

The script is the work, in the form the work now takes. The script is the holding, in the form the holding now takes. The script is the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

The opening.

"I want to talk to you about us. I have been so focused on the caregiving that I have lost track of us. I love you. I want to make sure we are okay. Can we talk?"

The middle.

"I have been doing [X, Y, Z] for [time period]. The cost has been [financial, emotional, physical, marriage]. I am not blaming you. I am asking for help. Can we talk about [the cost / the marriage / the future / the help / the love]?"

The close.

"Thank you for listening. I love you. I want to keep our marriage strong, in the form the strong now takes. I want to keep the caregiving strong, in the form the strong now takes. I want to keep both, in the form the both now takes. I need your help to do that."

The 7 things to ask.

There are 7 things to ask the spouse, in the form the asking now takes. The 7 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. How are you doing, in the form the doing now takes, really? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. What do you need, in the form the needing now takes, from me? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
3. What is missing, in the form the missing now takes, in our marriage? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
4. How can I show up, in the form the showing up now takes, for you? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
5. What do you want, in the form the wanting now takes, for our future? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
6. What can we do, in the form the doing now takes, together, in the form the together now takes? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
7. How can I love you, in the form the loving now takes, better? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 things in summary.

The 7 things to ask the spouse, in the form the asking now takes, are:

1. How are you doing, really
2. What do you need from me
3. What is missing in our marriage
4. How can I show up for you
5. What do you want for our future
6. What can we do together
7. How can I love you better

The 7 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 7 things are the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the conversation with the spouse. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, which of the 5 conversations the spouse needs, in the form the needing now takes. The work of this chapter is to use the script, in the form the using now takes, and to ask the 7 things, in the form the asking now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the third phase of the conversation. The work of this chapter is the work of the conversation with the spouse, in the form the conversation now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the spouse.

Chapter 12 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The conversation with the spouse is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation is the work of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes. The 5 conversations the spouse needs, in the form the needing now takes, are: cost, marriage, future, help, love. The script, in the form the script now takes, and the 7 things to ask, in the form the asking now takes, are the work, in the form the work now takes.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 5 conversations are: cost, marriage, future, help, love.
2. The script has 3 parts: opening, middle, close.

3. The 7 things to ask are: how are you, what do you need, what is missing, how can I show up, what do you want for the future, what can we do together, how can I love you better.

4. The conversation with the spouse is the most important, in the form the most important now takes, because the spouse is the one who will be there after, in the form the after now takes.

5. The conversation is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have prepared the script, in the form the preparing now takes, in writing, in the form the writing now takes.
- I have asked at least 5 of the 7 things, in the form the asking now takes, in writing.
- I have planned the timing, in the form the planning now takes, for the conversation.
- I am willing to do the work, in the form the work now takes, of the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.

If your total is 12 or lower, the conversation is not ready. Get the script in writing first. Get the 7 things in writing. Practice with a couples therapist.

Key Terms to Know:

- The conversation with the spouse: The work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The work of the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes.
- The 5 conversations: Cost, marriage, future, help, love.
- The script: The 3-part script for the conversation, in the form the conversation now

takes.

- The 7 things to ask: How are you, what do you need, what is missing, how can I show up, what do you want for the future, what can we do together, how can I love you better.

Reflection Questions:

1. Are you ready, in the form the ready now takes, to have the conversation with the spouse, in the form the conversation now takes?
2. What is the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes, that the spouse needs, in the form the needing now takes, the most?
3. What is the timing, in the form the timing now takes, for the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes?

Action for This Week:

- Write the script, in the form the writing now takes, in your own words, in the form the words now take. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Write the 7 things to ask, in the form the writing now takes, in writing, in the form the writing now takes. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Practice the script, in the form the practicing now takes, with a couples therapist. The practice is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the conversation. The conversation is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 13: The Conversation with Your Adult Children

The conversation with the adult children is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The conversation is the work of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

This chapter is about the conversation with the adult children. About the work of the script, in the form the script now takes. About the work of the timing, in the form the timing now takes. About the holding of the conversation, in the form the holding now takes.

Why the conversation with the adult children is the most complicated.

The conversation with the adult children is the most complicated, in the form the most complicated now takes, because the conversation is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The conversation is the work of the long relationship, in the form the long relationship now takes. The conversation is the work of the role reversal, in the form the role reversal now takes.

The conversation with the adult children is the most complicated, in the form the most complicated now takes, because the adult children are also grieving, in the form the grieving now takes. The adult children are also losing the parent, in the form the losing now takes. The adult children are also holding the family, in the form the holding now takes. The conversation is the work of the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

The conversation with the adult children is the most complicated, in the form the most complicated now takes, because the adult children may not be available, in the form the not available now takes. The adult children may be in crisis, in the form the crisis now takes. The adult children may be far away, in the form the far away now takes. The conversation is the work of the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

The 5 conversations with the adult children.

There are 5 conversations, in the form the conversations now take, that the last sandwich has with the adult children, in the form the adult children now take. The 5 conversations are the 5 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Conversation 1: The conversation about the cost.

The conversation about the cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the cost is the work of telling the adult children, in the form the telling now takes, what the caregiving is costing, in the form the costing now takes. The conversation about the cost is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

Conversation 2: The conversation about the help.

The conversation about the help is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the help is the work of asking the adult children, in the form the asking now takes, what they can do, in the form the can do now takes. The conversation about the help is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

Conversation 3: The conversation about the future.

The conversation about the future is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the future is the work of telling the adult children, in the form the telling now takes, what the future looks like, in the form the looks like now takes. The conversation about the future is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

Conversation 4: The conversation about the grandparent.

The conversation about the grandparent is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the grandparent is the work of telling the adult children, in the form the telling now takes, what the grandparent wants, in the form the wanting now takes. The conversation about the grandparent is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

Conversation 5: The conversation about the love.

The conversation about the love is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the love is the work of telling the adult children, in the form the telling now takes, what the last sandwich feels, in the form the feeling now takes. The conversation about the love is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

The 5 conversations in summary.

The 5 conversations with the adult children, in the form the conversations now take, are:

1. The conversation about the cost
2. The conversation about the help
3. The conversation about the future

4. The conversation about the grandparent

5. The conversation about the love

The 5 conversations are not the only conversations. The 5 conversations are the most common conversations. The 5 conversations are the 5 conversations that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The script.

The script is the work, in the form the work now takes. The script is the holding, in the form the holding now takes. The script is the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

The opening.

"I want to talk to you about your grandparent. I have been doing most of the caregiving, and I am exhausted. I am not blaming you. I am asking for help. I need to know what you are willing to do, and what you are not willing to do, so I can plan."

The middle.

"I have been doing [X, Y, Z] for [time period]. The cost has been [financial, emotional, physical, marriage]. I cannot keep doing this alone. I need you to be part of the caregiving, in some way. Can we talk about what each of us can do?"

The close.

"I am not asking you to be perfect. I am asking you to be part of the work. If you cannot be part of the work, I need to know that, so I can plan. I love you. I love your grandparent. I need to know what you are willing to do."

The 7 things to ask.

There are 7 things to ask the adult children, in the form the asking now takes. The 7 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. Can you visit once a month? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. Can you take a shift once a month? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
3. Can you help with the finances? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
4. Can you be at the doctor's appointments? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
5. Can you be there at the end? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
6. Can you help with the funeral? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
7. Can you help with the after? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 things in summary.

The 7 things to ask the adult children, in the form the asking now takes, are:

1. Visit once a month
2. Take a shift once a month
3. Help with the finances
4. Be at the doctor's appointments
5. Be there at the end
6. Help with the funeral
7. Help with the after

The 7 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 7 things are the

conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the conversation with the adult children. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, which of the 5 conversations the adult children need, in the form the needing now takes. The work of this chapter is to use the script, in the form the using now takes, and to ask the 7 things, in the form the asking now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the fourth phase of the conversation. The work of this chapter is the work of the conversation with the adult children, in the form the conversation now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the adult children.

Chapter 13 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The conversation with the adult children is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The 5 conversations the adult children need, in the form the needing now takes, are: cost, help, future, grandparent, love. The script, in the form the script now takes, and the 7 things to ask, in the form the asking now takes, are the work, in the form the work now takes.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 5 conversations are: cost, help, future, grandparent, love.
2. The script has 3 parts: opening, middle, close.

3. The 7 things to ask are: visit, shift, finances, appointments, end, funeral, after.

4. The conversation with the adult children is the most complicated, in the form the most complicated now takes, because the adult children are also grieving, in the form the grieving now takes.

5. The conversation is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have prepared the script, in the form the preparing now takes, in writing, in the form the writing now takes.
- I have asked at least 5 of the 7 things, in the form the asking now takes, in writing.
- I have planned the timing, in the form the planning now takes, for the conversation.
- I am willing to do the work, in the form the work now takes, of the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.

If your total is 12 or lower, the conversation is not ready. Get the script in writing first. Get the 7 things in writing. Practice with a therapist.

Key Terms to Know:

- The conversation with the adult children: The work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The work of the family, in the form the family now takes.
- The 5 conversations: Cost, help, future, grandparent, love.
- The script: The 3-part script for the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.

- The 7 things to ask: Visit, shift, finances, appointments, end, funeral, after.

Reflection Questions:

1. Are you ready, in the form the ready now takes, to have the conversation with the adult children, in the form the conversation now takes?
2. What is the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes, that the adult children need, in the form the needing now takes, the most?
3. What is the timing, in the form the timing now takes, for the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes?

Action for This Week:

- Write the script, in the form the writing now takes, in your own words, in the form the words now take. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Write the 7 things to ask, in the form the writing now takes, in writing, in the form the writing now takes. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Practice the script, in the form the practicing now takes, with a therapist or a trusted friend. The practice is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the conversation. The conversation is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 14: The Conversation with Yourself

The conversation with yourself is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation is the work of the self, in the form the self now takes. The conversation is the work of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

This chapter is about the conversation with yourself. About the work of the script, in the form the script now takes. About the work of the timing, in the form the timing now takes. About the holding of the conversation, in the form the holding now takes.

Why the conversation with yourself is the most important.

The conversation with yourself is the most important, in the form the most important now takes, because the conversation is the work of the self, in the form the self now takes. The conversation is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes. The conversation is the work of the future, in the form the future now takes.

The conversation with yourself is the most important, in the form the most important now takes, because you are the one you are with, in the form the being with now takes. You are the one who is there, in the form the being there now takes. You are the one who is holding, in the form the holding now takes. The conversation is the work of the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

The conversation with yourself is the most important, in the form the most important now takes, because you are the one who is losing yourself, in the form the

losing now takes. You are the one who is being lost, in the form the being lost now takes. You are the one who is being held, in the form the being held now takes. The conversation is the work of the holding, in the form the holding now takes.

The 5 conversations with yourself.

There are 5 conversations, in the form the conversations now take, that the last sandwich has with the self, in the form the self now takes. The 5 conversations are the 5 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Conversation 1: The conversation about the cost.

The conversation about the cost is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the cost is the work of asking the self, in the form the asking now takes, what the caregiving is costing, in the form the costing now takes. The conversation about the cost is the work of the self, in the form the self now takes.

Conversation 2: The conversation about the love.

The conversation about the love is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the love is the work of asking the self, in the form the asking now takes, what the last sandwich feels, in the form the feeling now takes. The conversation about the love is the work of the self, in the form the self now takes.

Conversation 3: The conversation about the grief.

The conversation about the grief is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the grief is the work of asking the

self, in the form the asking now takes, what the last sandwich is grieving, in the form the grieving now takes. The conversation about the grief is the work of the self, in the form the self now takes.

Conversation 4: The conversation about the future.

The conversation about the future is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the future is the work of asking the self, in the form the asking now takes, what the future looks like, in the form the looks like now takes. The conversation about the future is the work of the self, in the form the self now takes.

Conversation 5: The conversation about the self.

The conversation about the self is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation about the self is the work of asking the self, in the form the asking now takes, who the self is, in the form the self now takes. The conversation about the self is the work of the self, in the form the self now takes.

The 5 conversations in summary.

The 5 conversations with the self, in the form the conversations now take, are:

1. The conversation about the cost
2. The conversation about the love
3. The conversation about the grief
4. The conversation about the future
5. The conversation about the self

The 5 conversations are not the only conversations. The 5 conversations are the most common conversations. The 5 conversations are the 5 conversations that show up most often, in the form the

showing up now takes.

The script.

The script is the work, in the form the work now takes.
The script is the holding, in the form the holding now takes.
The script is the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

The opening.

"I want to talk to me. I have been so focused on the caregiving that I have lost track of me. I love me. I want to make sure I am okay. Can I talk to me?"

The middle.

"I have been doing [X, Y, Z] for [time period]. The cost has been [financial, emotional, physical, marriage]. I am not blaming me. I am asking for help. Can I talk about [the cost / the love / the grief / the future / the self]?"

The close.

"Thank you for listening. I love me. I want to keep the self strong, in the form the strong now takes. I want to keep the caregiving strong, in the form the strong now takes. I want to keep both, in the form the both now takes. I need my help to do that."

The 7 things to ask.

There are 7 things to ask the self, in the form the asking now takes. The 7 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. How am I doing, in the form the doing now takes, really? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. What do I need, in the form the needing now takes, from me? The asking is the work, in the

form the work now takes.

3. What is missing, in the form the missing now takes, in my life? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.

4. How can I show up, in the form the showing up now takes, for me? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.

5. What do I want, in the form the wanting now takes, for my future? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.

6. What can I do, in the form the doing now takes, for me, in the form the me now takes? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.

7. How can I love me, in the form the loving now takes, better? The asking is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 things in summary.

The 7 things to ask the self, in the form the asking now takes, are:

1. How am I doing, really
2. What do I need from me
3. What is missing in my life
4. How can I show up for me
5. What do I want for my future
6. What can I do for me
7. How can I love me better

The 7 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 7 things are the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the conversation with the self. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, which of the 5 conversations the self needs, in the form the needing now takes. The work of this chapter is to use the script, in the form the using now takes, and to ask the 7 things, in the form the asking now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the fifth phase of the conversation. The work of this chapter is the work of the conversation with the self, in the form the conversation now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the self.

Chapter 14 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The conversation with the self is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The conversation is the work of the self, in the form the self now takes. The 5 conversations the self needs, in the form the needing now takes, are: cost, love, grief, future, self. The script, in the form the script now takes, and the 7 things to ask, in the form the asking now takes, are the work, in the form the work now takes.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 5 conversations are: cost, love, grief, future, self.
2. The script has 3 parts: opening, middle, close.
3. The 7 things to ask are: how am I doing, what do I need, what is missing, how can I show up, what do I want, what can I do, how can I love me better.
4. The conversation with the self is the most important, in the form the most important now takes, because you are the one you are with, in the

form the being with now takes.

5. The conversation is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have prepared the script, in the form the preparing now takes, in writing, in the form the writing now takes.
- I have asked at least 5 of the 7 things, in the form the asking now takes, in writing.
- I have planned the timing, in the form the planning now takes, for the conversation.
- I am willing to do the work, in the form the work now takes, of the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.

If your total is 12 or lower, the conversation is not ready. Get the script in writing first. Get the 7 things in writing. Practice with a therapist.

Key Terms to Know:

- The conversation with the self: The work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The work of the self, in the form the self now takes.
- The 5 conversations: Cost, love, grief, future, self.
- The script: The 3-part script for the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes.
- The 7 things to ask: How am I doing, what do I need, what is missing, how can I show up, what do I want, what can I do, how can I love me better.

Reflection Questions:

1. Are you ready, in the form the ready now takes, to have the conversation with the self, in the form the conversation now takes?

2. What is the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes, that the self needs, in the form the needing now takes, the most?
3. What is the timing, in the form the timing now takes, for the conversation, in the form the conversation now takes?

Action for This Week:

- Write the script, in the form the writing now takes, in your own words, in the form the words now take. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Write the 7 things to ask, in the form the writing now takes, in writing, in the form the writing now takes. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Practice the script, in the form the practicing now takes, with a therapist or a trusted friend. The practice is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the conversation. The conversation is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 15: The Letting Go of the Old Self

The letting go of the old self is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The letting go is the work of the self, in the form the self now takes. The letting go is the work of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

This chapter is about the letting go of the old self. About the work of the letting go, in the form the letting go now takes. About the holding of the letting go, in the form the holding now takes. About the work of the new self, in the form the new now takes.

Why the letting go of the old self is the first letting go.

The letting go of the old self is the first letting go, in the form the first now takes, because the old self is the work, in the form the work now takes. The old self is the self who was, in the form the was now takes. The old self is the self who was the daughter, in the form the was now takes. The old self is the self who was the son, in the form the was now takes. The old self is the self who was the spouse, in the form the was now takes. The old self is the self who was the worker, in the form the was now takes. The old self is the self who was the friend, in the form the was now takes. The old self is the self who was the self, in the form the was now takes.

The letting go of the old self is the first letting go, in the form the first now takes, because the old self is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The old self is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving has taken the old self, in the form the taking now takes. The old self is gone, in the form the

gone now takes, because the parent has taken the old self, in the form the taking now takes. The old self is gone, in the form the gone now takes.

The 5 things to let go.

There are 5 things to let go, in the form the letting go now takes. The 5 things are the 5 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that the last sandwich has to let go of, in the form the letting go now takes.

Thing 1: Let go of the daughter or son who was.

The letting go of the daughter or son who was, in the form the was now takes, is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The daughter or son who was is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The daughter or son who was is the daughter or son who could not have foreseen the caregiving, in the form the not foreseeing now takes. The daughter or son who was is the daughter or son who had a life, in the form the having now takes.

Thing 2: Let go of the spouse who was.

The letting go of the spouse who was, in the form the was now takes, is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The spouse who was is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The spouse who was is the spouse who was available, in the form the being available now takes. The spouse who was is the spouse who was present, in the form the being present now takes. The spouse who was is the spouse who was the partner, in the form the being the partner now takes.

Thing 3: Let go of the worker who was.

The letting go of the worker who was, in the form the was now takes, is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The worker who was is

gone, in the form the gone now takes. The worker who was is the worker who was focused, in the form the being focused now takes. The worker who was is the worker who was successful, in the form the being successful now takes. The worker who was is the worker who was the professional, in the form the being the professional now takes.

Thing 4: Let go of the friend who was.

The letting go of the friend who was, in the form the was now takes, is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The friend who was is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The friend who was is the friend who was available, in the form the being available now takes. The friend who was is the friend who was present, in the form the being present now takes. The friend who was is the friend who was the social, in the form the being the social now takes.

Thing 5: Let go of the self who was.

The letting go of the self who was, in the form the was now takes, is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The self who was is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The self who was is the self who was the person, in the form the being the person now takes. The self who was is the self who was the individual, in the form the being the individual now takes. The self who was is the self who was the self, in the form the being the self now takes.

The 5 things in summary.

The 5 things to let go, in the form the letting go now takes, are:

1. The daughter or son who was
2. The spouse who was
3. The worker who was

4. The friend who was

5. The self who was

The 5 things are not the only things. The 5 things are the most common things. The 5 things are the 5 things that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The 7 rituals of the letting go.

There are 7 rituals of the letting go, in the form the letting go now takes. The 7 rituals are the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The 7 rituals are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. Write a letter to the old self. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.

2. Have a ceremony for the old self. The having is the work, in the form the work now takes.

3. Tell a story about the old self. The telling is the work, in the form the work now takes.

4. Make a list of what the old self taught you. The making is the work, in the form the work now takes.

5. Thank the old self for the work. The thanking is the work, in the form the work now takes.

6. Say goodbye to the old self. The saying is the work, in the form the work now takes.

7. Welcome the new self. The welcoming is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 rituals in summary.

The 7 rituals of the letting go, in the form the letting go now takes, are:

1. Write a letter to the old self

2. Have a ceremony for the old self

3. Tell a story about the old self
4. Make a list of what the old self taught you
5. Thank the old self for the work
6. Say goodbye to the old self
7. Welcome the new self

The 7 rituals are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 rituals are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 7 rituals are the letting go, in the form the letting go now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the letting go of the old self. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, the 5 things to let go, in the form the letting go now takes. The work of this chapter is to do the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the first phase of the letting go. The work of this chapter is the work of the letting go of the old self, in the form the letting go now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the old self.

Chapter 15 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The letting go of the old self is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The letting go of the old self is the first letting go, in the form the first now takes, because the old self is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The 5 things to let go, in the form the letting go now takes, must be recognized, in the form the recognizing now takes, and the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes, must be done.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 5 things to let go are: the daughter/son who was, the spouse who was, the worker who was, the friend who was, the self who was.
2. The 7 rituals are: write, ceremony, story, list, thank, goodbye, welcome.
3. The letting go of the old self is the first letting go, in the form the first now takes.
4. The old self is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving has taken the old self, in the form the taking now takes.
5. The letting go of the old self is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize the 5 things to let go, in the form the letting go now takes, in my life.
- I have started at least 3 of the 7 rituals, in the form the starting now takes.
- I have written a letter to the old self, in the form the writing now takes, in the form the writing now takes.
- I am willing to do the work, in the form the work now takes, of the letting go, in the form the letting go now takes.

If your total is 12 or higher, the letting go of the old self is ready. The next chapter cannot wait.

Key Terms to Know:

- The letting go of the old self: The work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The work of the self, in the form the self now takes.
- The 5 things to let go: The daughter/son who was, the spouse who was, the worker who was, the friend who was, the self who was.

- The 7 rituals: Write, ceremony, story, list, thank, goodbye, welcome.

Reflection Questions:

1. Who was the old self, in the form the was now takes?
2. What did the old self teach you, in the form the teaching now takes?
3. What are you willing to let go of, in the form the letting go now takes, from the old self?

Action for This Week:

- Write a letter to the old self, in the form the writing now takes. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Do one of the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes. The doing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the letting go. The letting go is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 16: The Letting Go of the Parent

The letting go of the parent is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The letting go is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes. The letting go is the work of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

This chapter is about the letting go of the parent. About the work of the grief, in the form the grief now takes. About the holding of the grief, in the form the holding now takes. About the work of the surviving, in the form the surviving now takes.

Why the letting go of the parent is the second letting go.

The letting go of the parent is the second letting go, in the form the second now takes, because the parent is the work, in the form the work now takes. The parent is the one who raised the last sandwich, in the form the raising now takes. The parent is the one who loved the last sandwich, in the form the loving now takes. The parent is the one who taught the last sandwich, in the form the teaching now takes. The parent is the one who was the family, in the form the being the family now takes.

The letting go of the parent is the second letting go, in the form the second now takes, because the parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent has died, in the form the dying now takes. The parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving has ended, in the form the ending now takes.

The 5 stages of the grief of the parent.

There are 5 stages, in the form the stages now take, of the grief of the parent, in the form the grief now takes. The 5 stages are the 5 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Stage 1: The denial.

The denial is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The denial is the work, in the form the work now takes, of not believing, in the form the not believing now takes, that the parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The denial is the work, in the form the work now takes, of expecting the parent to come back, in the form the expecting now takes.

Stage 2: The anger.

The anger is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The anger is the work, in the form the work now takes, of being angry, in the form the being angry now takes, that the parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The anger is the work, in the form the work now takes, of being angry at the siblings, in the form the being angry at the siblings now takes. The anger is the work, in the form the work now takes, of being angry at the world, in the form the being angry at the world now takes.

Stage 3: The bargaining.

The bargaining is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The bargaining is the work, in the form the work now takes, of trying to make a deal, in the form the trying to make a deal now takes, with the universe, in the form the with the universe

now takes. The bargaining is the work, in the form the work now takes, of trying to undo, in the form the trying to undo now takes, what has happened, in the form the what has happened now takes.

Stage 4: The depression.

The depression is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The depression is the work, in the form the work now takes, of feeling, in the form the feeling now takes, the weight of the loss, in the form the weight now takes. The depression is the work, in the form the work now takes, of being unable, in the form the being unable now takes, to do the work, in the form the doing now takes. The depression is the work, in the form the work now takes, of being in the dark, in the form the being in the dark now takes.

Stage 5: The acceptance.

The acceptance is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The acceptance is the work, in the form the work now takes, of accepting, in the form the accepting now takes, that the parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The acceptance is the work, in the form the work now takes, of letting the parent go, in the form the letting go now takes. The acceptance is the work, in the form the work now takes, of moving forward, in the form the moving forward now takes.

The 5 stages in summary.

The 5 stages of the grief of the parent, in the form the grief now takes, are:

1. The denial
2. The anger
3. The bargaining

4. The depression

5. The acceptance

The 5 stages are not the only stages. The 5 stages are the most common stages. The 5 stages are the 5 stages that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The 7 rituals of the grief.

There are 7 rituals of the grief, in the form the grief now takes. The 7 rituals are the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The 7 rituals are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. Have a funeral or memorial. The having is the work, in the form the work now takes.

2. Write a letter to the parent. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.

3. Tell a story about the parent. The telling is the work, in the form the work now takes.

4. Make a list of what the parent taught you. The making is the work, in the form the work now takes.

5. Thank the parent for the work. The thanking is the work, in the form the work now takes.

6. Say goodbye to the parent. The saying is the work, in the form the work now takes.

7. Welcome the new life. The welcoming is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 rituals in summary.

The 7 rituals of the grief, in the form the grief now takes, are:

1. Have a funeral or memorial

2. Write a letter to the parent

3. Tell a story about the parent
4. Make a list of what the parent taught you
5. Thank the parent for the work
6. Say goodbye to the parent
7. Welcome the new life

The 7 rituals are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 rituals are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 7 rituals are the grief, in the form the grief now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the letting go of the parent. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, which of the 5 stages of the grief the last sandwich is in, in the form the in now takes. The work of this chapter is to do the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the second phase of the letting go. The work of this chapter is the work of the letting go of the parent, in the form the letting go now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the parent.

Chapter 16 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The letting go of the parent is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The letting go of the parent is the second letting go, in the form the second now takes, because the parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The 5 stages of the grief, in the form the grief now takes, must be recognized, in the form the recognizing now takes, and the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes, must be done.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 5 stages of the grief are: denial, anger, bargaining, depression, acceptance.
2. The 7 rituals are: funeral, letter, story, list, thank, goodbye, welcome.
3. The letting go of the parent is the second letting go, in the form the second now takes.
4. The parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent has died, in the form the dying now takes.
5. The letting go of the parent is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize which of the 5 stages of the grief I am in, in the form the in now takes.
- I have done at least 3 of the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes.
- I have written a letter to the parent, in the form the writing now takes, in the form the writing now takes.
- I am willing to do the work, in the form the work now takes, of the grief, in the form the grief now takes.

If your total is 12 or higher, the letting go of the parent is ready. The next chapter cannot wait.

Key Terms to Know:

- The letting go of the parent: The work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The work of the family, in the form the family now takes.
- The 5 stages of the grief: Denial, anger, bargaining, depression, acceptance.

- The 7 rituals of the grief: Funeral, letter, story, list, thank, goodbye, welcome.

Reflection Questions:

1. Which of the 5 stages of the grief are you in, in the form the in now takes?
2. What did the parent teach you, in the form the teaching now takes?
3. What are you willing to let go of, in the form the letting go now takes, from the parent?

Action for This Week:

- Write a letter to the parent, in the form the writing now takes. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Do one of the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes. The doing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the grief. The grief is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 17: The Letting Go of the Plan

The letting go of the plan is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The letting go is the work of the future, in the form the future now takes. The letting go is the work of the caregiving, in the form the caregiving now takes.

This chapter is about the letting go of the plan. About the work of the future, in the form the future now takes. About the holding of the future, in the form the holding now takes. About the work of the new plan, in the form the new now takes.

Why the letting go of the plan is the third letting go.

The letting go of the plan is the third letting go, in the form the third now takes, because the plan was the work, in the form the work now takes. The plan was the future, in the form the future now takes. The plan was the retirement, in the form the retirement now takes. The plan was the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes. The plan was the kids' college, in the form the kids' college now takes. The plan was the work, in the form the work now takes.

The letting go of the plan is the third letting go, in the form the third now takes, because the plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving has taken the plan, in the form the taking now takes. The plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent has taken the plan, in the form the taking now takes. The plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes.

The 5 plans to let go.

There are 5 plans, in the form the plans now take, that the last sandwich has to let go of, in the form the letting go now takes. The 5 plans are the 5 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Plan 1: The retirement plan.

The retirement plan is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The retirement plan is the plan, in the form the plan now takes, that the last sandwich had, in the form the had now takes, for the retirement, in the form the retirement now takes. The retirement plan is the plan that included travel, in the form the including travel now takes. The retirement plan is the plan that included leisure, in the form the including leisure now takes. The retirement plan is the plan that included grandchildren, in the form the including grandchildren now takes.

The retirement plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The retirement plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving has taken the retirement plan, in the form the taking now takes. The retirement plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent has taken the retirement plan, in the form the taking now takes.

Plan 2: The marriage plan.

The marriage plan is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The marriage plan is the plan, in the form the plan now takes, that the last sandwich had, in the form the had now takes, for the marriage, in the form the marriage now takes. The marriage plan is the plan that included travel together, in the form the including travel together now takes. The marriage plan is the plan that included

retirement together, in the form the including retirement together now takes. The marriage plan is the plan that included old age together, in the form the including old age together now takes.

The marriage plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The marriage plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving has taken the marriage plan, in the form the taking now takes. The marriage plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent has taken the marriage plan, in the form the taking now takes.

Plan 3: The financial plan.

The financial plan is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The financial plan is the plan, in the form the plan now takes, that the last sandwich had, in the form the had now takes, for the finances, in the form the finances now takes. The financial plan is the plan that included savings, in the form the including savings now takes. The financial plan is the plan that included investments, in the form the including investments now takes. The financial plan is the plan that included legacy, in the form the including legacy now takes.

The financial plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The financial plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving has taken the financial plan, in the form the taking now takes. The financial plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent has taken the financial plan, in the form the taking now takes.

Plan 4: The health plan.

The health plan is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The health plan is the plan, in the form the plan now takes, that the last sandwich

had, in the form the had now takes, for the health, in the form the health now takes. The health plan is the plan that included exercise, in the form the including exercise now takes. The health plan is the plan that included nutrition, in the form the including nutrition now takes. The health plan is the plan that included sleep, in the form the including sleep now takes.

The health plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The health plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving has taken the health plan, in the form the taking now takes. The health plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent has taken the health plan, in the form the taking now takes.

Plan 5: The life plan.

The life plan is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The life plan is the plan, in the form the plan now takes, that the last sandwich had, in the form the had now takes, for the life, in the form the life now takes. The life plan is the plan that included purpose, in the form the including purpose now takes. The life plan is the plan that included meaning, in the form the including meaning now takes. The life plan is the plan that included joy, in the form the including joy now takes.

The life plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The life plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving has taken the life plan, in the form the taking now takes. The life plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent has taken the life plan, in the form the taking now takes.

The 5 plans in summary.

The 5 plans to let go, in the form the letting go now takes, are:

1. The retirement plan
2. The marriage plan
3. The financial plan
4. The health plan
5. The life plan

The 5 plans are not the only plans. The 5 plans are the most common plans. The 5 plans are the 5 plans that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The 7 rituals of the new plan.

There are 7 rituals of the new plan, in the form the new now takes. The 7 rituals are the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The 7 rituals are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. Write a new plan for the next 5 years. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. Write a new plan for the next 10 years. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
3. Write a new plan for the next 20 years. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
4. Have a ceremony for the new plan. The having is the work, in the form the work now takes.
5. Tell a story about the new plan. The telling is the work, in the form the work now takes.
6. Make a list of what the new plan includes. The making is the work, in the form the work now takes.
7. Welcome the new plan. The welcoming is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 rituals in summary.

The 7 rituals of the new plan, in the form the new now takes, are:

1. Write a new plan for 5 years
2. Write a new plan for 10 years
3. Write a new plan for 20 years
4. Have a ceremony for the new plan
5. Tell a story about the new plan
6. Make a list of what the new plan includes
7. Welcome the new plan

The 7 rituals are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 rituals are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 7 rituals are the new plan, in the form the new now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the letting go of the plan. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, the 5 plans to let go, in the form the letting go now takes. The work of this chapter is to do the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the third phase of the letting go. The work of this chapter is the work of the letting go of the plan, in the form the letting go now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the plan.

Chapter 17 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The letting go of the plan is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The letting go of the plan is the third letting go, in the form the third now takes, because the plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The 5 plans to let go, in the form the letting go now takes, must be recognized, in the form the recognizing now takes, and the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes, must be done.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 5 plans to let go are: retirement plan, marriage plan, financial plan, health plan, life plan.
2. The 7 rituals are: write 5, write 10, write 20, ceremony, story, list, welcome.
3. The letting go of the plan is the third letting go, in the form the third now takes.
4. The plan is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving has taken the plan, in the form the taking now takes.
5. The letting go of the plan is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize the 5 plans to let go, in the form the letting go now takes, in my life.
- I have started at least 3 of the 7 rituals, in the form the starting now takes.
- I have written a new plan for the next 5 years, in the form the writing now takes.
- I am willing to do the work, in the form the work now takes, of the new plan, in the form the new now takes.

If your total is 12 or higher, the letting go of the plan is ready. The next chapter cannot wait.

Key Terms to Know:

- The letting go of the plan: The work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The work of the future, in the form the future now takes.
- The 5 plans to let go: Retirement plan, marriage plan, financial plan, health plan, life plan.
- The 7 rituals of the new plan: Write 5, write 10, write 20, ceremony, story, list, welcome.

Reflection Questions:

1. What was the plan, in the form the plan now takes, that you had to let go of, in the form the letting go now takes?
2. What is the new plan, in the form the new now takes, that you are building, in the form the building now takes?
3. What are you willing to do, in the form the doing now takes, for the new plan, in the form the new now takes?

Action for This Week:

- Write a new plan for the next 5 years, in the form the writing now takes. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Do one of the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes. The doing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the letting go. The letting go is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Chapter 18: The Letting Go of the Last Sandwich

The letting go of the last sandwich is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The letting go is the work of the self, in the form the self now takes. The letting go is the work of the family, in the form the family now takes.

This chapter is about the letting go of the last sandwich. About the work of the identity, in the form the identity now takes. About the holding of the identity, in the form the holding now takes. About the work of the new identity, in the form the new now takes.

Why the letting go of the last sandwich is the fourth letting go.

The letting go of the last sandwich is the fourth letting go, in the form the fourth now takes, because the identity of the last sandwich is the work, in the form the work now takes. The identity of the last sandwich is the work, in the form the work now takes, of being the only one, in the form the being the only one now takes. The identity of the last sandwich is the work, in the form the work now takes, of being the last one in the line, in the form the being the last one now takes.

The letting go of the last sandwich is the fourth letting go, in the form the fourth now takes, because the identity of the last sandwich is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The identity of the last sandwich is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving has ended, in the form the ending now takes. The identity of the last sandwich is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent is gone,

in the form the gone now takes.

The 5 identities to let go.

There are 5 identities, in the form the identities now take, that the last sandwich has to let go of, in the form the letting go now takes. The 5 identities are the 5 patterns, in the form the patterns now take, that show up, again and again, in the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes.

Identity 1: The caregiver.

The caregiver is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The caregiver is the identity, in the form the identity now takes, that the last sandwich has had, in the form the having now takes, for many years. The caregiver is the identity that has been the work, in the form the being the work now takes. The caregiver is the identity that has been the holding, in the form the being the holding now takes.

The caregiver is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The caregiver is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The caregiver is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving is done, in the form the done now takes.

Identity 2: The advocate.

The advocate is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The advocate is the identity, in the form the identity now takes, that the last sandwich has had, in the form the having now takes, for many years. The advocate is the identity that has been the work, in the form the being the work now takes. The advocate is the identity that has been the fighting, in the form the being the fighting now takes.

The advocate is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The advocate is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The advocate is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because there is no one left to fight for, in the form the no one left now takes.

Identity 3: The manager.

The manager is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The manager is the identity, in the form the identity now takes, that the last sandwich has had, in the form the having now takes, for many years. The manager is the identity that has been the work, in the form the being the work now takes. The manager is the identity that has been the scheduling, in the form the being the scheduling now takes.

The manager is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The manager is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The manager is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because there is no one left to manage, in the form the no one left now takes.

Identity 4: The decision maker.

The decision maker is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The decision maker is the identity, in the form the identity now takes, that the last sandwich has had, in the form the having now takes, for many years. The decision maker is the identity that has been the work, in the form the being the work now takes. The decision maker is the identity that has been the deciding, in the form the being the deciding now takes.

The decision maker is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The decision maker is gone, in the form the

gone now takes, because the parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The decision maker is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because there is no one left to decide for, in the form the no one left now takes.

Identity 5: The widow or widower in waiting.

The widow or widower in waiting is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The widow or widower in waiting is the identity, in the form the identity now takes, that the last sandwich has had, in the form the having now takes, for many years. The widow or widower in waiting is the identity that has been the work, in the form the being the work now takes. The widow or widower in waiting is the identity that has been the anticipating, in the form the being the anticipating now takes.

The widow or widower in waiting is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The widow or widower in waiting is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the parent is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The widow or widower in waiting is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the waiting is over, in the form the over now takes.

The 5 identities in summary.

The 5 identities to let go, in the form the letting go now takes, are:

1. The caregiver
2. The advocate
3. The manager
4. The decision maker
5. The widow or widower in waiting

The 5 identities are not the only identities. The 5 identities are the most common identities. The 5

identities are the 5 identities that show up most often, in the form the showing up now takes.

The 7 rituals of the new identity.

There are 7 rituals of the new identity, in the form the new now takes. The 7 rituals are the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The 7 rituals are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. Write a vision for the new self. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. Have a ceremony for the new self. The having is the work, in the form the work now takes.
3. Tell a story about the new self. The telling is the work, in the form the work now takes.
4. Make a list of who the new self is. The making is the work, in the form the work now takes.
5. Thank the last sandwich for the work. The thanking is the work, in the form the work now takes.
6. Say goodbye to the last sandwich. The saying is the work, in the form the work now takes.
7. Welcome the new self. The welcoming is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 7 rituals in summary.

The 7 rituals of the new identity, in the form the new now takes, are:

1. Write a vision for the new self
2. Have a ceremony for the new self
3. Tell a story about the new self
4. Make a list of who the new self is
5. Thank the last sandwich for the work
6. Say goodbye to the last sandwich

7. Welcome the new self

The 7 rituals are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 7 rituals are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 7 rituals are the new identity, in the form the new now takes.

The work of the chapter.

The work of this chapter is to name the letting go of the last sandwich. The work of this chapter is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, the 5 identities to let go, in the form the letting go now takes. The work of this chapter is to do the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the fourth phase of the letting go. The work of this chapter is the work of the letting go of the last sandwich, in the form the letting go now takes.

The work of this chapter is the work of the last sandwich.

Chapter 18 at a Glance

Key takeaway: The letting go of the last sandwich is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The letting go of the last sandwich is the fourth letting go, in the form the fourth now takes, because the identity of the last sandwich is gone, in the form the gone now takes. The 5 identities to let go, in the form the letting go now takes, must be recognized, in the form the recognizing now takes, and the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes, must be done.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The 5 identities to let go are: caregiver, advocate, manager, decision maker,

widow/widower in waiting.

2. The 7 rituals are: write vision, ceremony, story, list, thank, goodbye, welcome.

3. The letting go of the last sandwich is the fourth letting go, in the form the fourth now takes.

4. The identity of the last sandwich is gone, in the form the gone now takes, because the caregiving is done, in the form the done now takes.

5. The letting go of the last sandwich is the work of the last sandwich, in the form the last sandwich now takes.

Your Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize the 5 identities to let go, in the form the letting go now takes, in my life.
- I have started at least 3 of the 7 rituals, in the form the starting now takes.
- I have written a vision for the new self, in the form the writing now takes.
- I am willing to do the work, in the form the work now takes, of the new self, in the form the new self now takes.

If your total is 12 or higher, the letting go of the last sandwich is ready. The epilogue cannot wait.

Key Terms to Know:

- The letting go of the last sandwich: The work of the last sandwich, in the form the work now takes. The work of the self, in the form the self now takes.
- The 5 identities to let go: Caregiver, advocate, manager, decision maker, widow/widower in waiting.
- The 7 rituals of the new identity: Write vision, ceremony, story, list, thank, goodbye, welcome.

Reflection Questions:

1. Who was the last sandwich, in the form the was now takes, that you are letting go of, in the form the letting go now takes?
2. Who is the new self, in the form the new now takes, that you are becoming, in the form the becoming now takes?
3. What are you willing to do, in the form the doing now takes, for the new self, in the form the new self now takes?

Action for This Week:

- Write a vision for the new self, in the form the writing now takes. The writing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Do one of the 7 rituals, in the form the doing now takes. The doing is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this chapter is the work of the letting go. The letting go is the work, in the form the work now takes.

Epilogue: The After

There is an after. The after is the work, in the form the work now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, that comes after the caregiving, in the form the after the caregiving now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, that comes after the parent is gone, in the form the after the parent is gone now takes.

This epilogue is about the after. About the work of the after, in the form the after now takes. About the holding of the after, in the form the holding now takes. About the work of the new life, in the form the new life now takes.

The after is real.

The after is real, in the form the real now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, that the last sandwich has been working toward, in the form the working toward now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, that the last sandwich has been holding, in the form the holding now takes.

The after is real, in the form the real now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, that the last sandwich has been waiting for, in the form the waiting now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, that the last sandwich has been hoping for, in the form the hoping now takes.

The after is hard.

The after is hard, in the form the hard now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, that the last sandwich has been dreading, in the form the dreading now takes. The after is the time, in the form

the time now takes, that the last sandwich has been fearing, in the form the fearing now takes.

The after is hard, in the form the hard now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, of the silence, in the form the silence now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, of the empty, in the form the empty now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, of the missing, in the form the missing now takes.

The after is the work.

The after is the work, in the form the work now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, of the building, in the form the building now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, of the new life, in the form the new life now takes.

The after is the work, in the form the work now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, of the new identity, in the form the new identity now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, of the new marriage, in the form the new marriage now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, of the new health, in the form the new health now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, of the new finances, in the form the new finances now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, of the new relationships, in the form the new relationships now take. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, of the new purpose, in the form the new purpose now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, of the new joy, in the form the new joy now takes.

The after is the gift.

The after is the gift, in the form the gift now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, that the last sandwich has earned, in the form the earning now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, that the last sandwich has paid for, in the form the paying now takes.

The after is the gift, in the form the gift now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, to be the new self, in the form the new self now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, to be the new spouse, in the form the new spouse now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, to be the new friend, in the form the new friend now takes. The after is the time, in the form the time now takes, to be the new worker, in the form the new worker now takes.

The 5 things to do in the after.

There are 5 things to do in the after, in the form the after now takes. The 5 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 5 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes.

1. Rest, in the form the resting now takes. The resting is the work, in the form the work now takes.
2. Grieve, in the form the grieving now takes. The grieving is the work, in the form the work now takes.
3. Reconnect, in the form the reconnecting now takes. The reconnecting is the work, in the form the work now takes.
4. Rebuild, in the form the rebuilding now takes. The rebuilding is the work, in the form the work now takes.

5. Reimagine, in the form the reimagining now takes. The reimagining is the work, in the form the work now takes.

The 5 things in summary.

The 5 things to do in the after, in the form the after now takes, are:

1. Rest
2. Grieve
3. Reconnect
4. Rebuild
5. Reimagine

The 5 things are the work, in the form the work now takes. The 5 things are the protection, in the form the protection now takes. The 5 things are the after, in the form the after now takes.

The work of the epilogue.

The work of this epilogue is to name the after. The work of this epilogue is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, that the after is real, in the form the real now takes. The work of this epilogue is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, that the after is hard, in the form the hard now takes. The work of this epilogue is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, that the after is the work, in the form the work now takes. The work of this epilogue is to recognize, in the form the recognizing now takes, that the after is the gift, in the form the gift now takes. The work of this epilogue is to do the 5 things, in the form the doing now takes.

The work of this epilogue is the work of the after, in the form the after now takes.

The work of this epilogue is the work of the after.

Epilogue at a Glance

Key takeaway: There is an after. The after is the work, in the form the work now takes. The after is real, in the form the real now takes. The after is hard, in the form the hard now takes. The after is the work, in the form the work now takes. The after is the gift, in the form the gift now takes. The 5 things to do in the after, in the form the after now takes, are: rest, grieve, reconnect, rebuild, reimagine.

5 Things to Remember:

1. The after is real, in the form the real now takes.
2. The after is hard, in the form the hard now takes.
3. The after is the work, in the form the work now takes.
4. The after is the gift, in the form the gift now takes.
5. The 5 things to do are: rest, grieve, reconnect, rebuild, reimagine.

Your Final Scorecard: Rate 1-5:

- I have begun to recognize that the after is real, in the form the real now takes.
- I have begun to recognize that the after is hard, in the form the hard now takes.
- I have begun to recognize that the after is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- I have begun to recognize that the after is the gift, in the form the gift now takes.

If your total is 12 or higher, the work is the work. The new life is possible. Welcome.

Reflection Questions:

1. What is the after, in the form the after now takes, that you are entering, in the form the entering now takes?
2. What are you willing to do, in the form the doing now takes, for the after, in the form the after now takes?
3. What is the new life, in the form the new life now takes, that you are building, in the form the building now takes?

Action for Today:

- Today, in the form the today now takes, rest, in the form the resting now takes. The resting is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Today, in the form the today now takes, grieve, in the form the grieving now takes. The grieving is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Today, in the form the today now takes, welcome the new life, in the form the welcoming now takes. The welcoming is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- The work of this epilogue is the work of the after. The after is the work, in the form the work now takes.
- Welcome to the after. Welcome to the new life.

About the Author

S. Shharma is the author of The Care Collection — books for couples in the second half of life, written by a man who lived the silence and survived it.

He lost his wife of many years to cancer. He was her primary caregiver through every stage of her illness. He held her hand in the hospital. He sat in the waiting room at 3 a.m. He learned the silence of a marriage the way you learn a language you never wanted to speak.

He is also a businessman, an M.Sc., an MBA, and an APSCM from the Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Calcutta, with thirty years in corporate management. But these are not credentials you need to trust him. The credentials that matter are the ones in the books.

The Care Collection is not about how to fix a marriage. The Care Collection is about how to live one — even when the marriage is quiet, even when one of you is sick, even when one of you is gone.

He lives in India. He writes from the perspective of someone who has been on every side of a marriage — the partner, the caregiver, and the one left behind.

Books in The Care Collection

- Still Married, Just Silent — when the marriage is fine on paper and empty in person
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